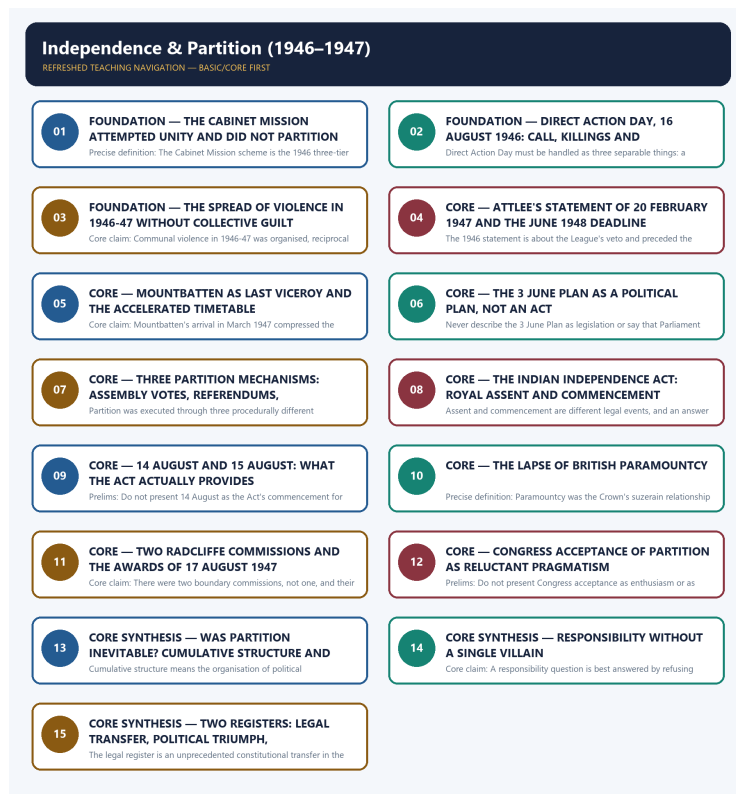


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Independence & Partition (1946-1947) - Learner-v2 Refreshed

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Independence & Partition (1946-1947) - Solved Practice Workbook

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Cabinet Mission attempted unity?

A. The Cabinet Mission of 1946 rejected a sovereign Pakistan and proposed a united three-tier scheme of Union, groups and provinces; it attempted to preserve unity and did not partition India, so Partition must be explained by the collapse of that scheme and by what followed it rather than by the Mission itself. B. Attlee announced on 20 February 1947 that Britain would transfer power to responsible Indian hands not later than June 1948, an announcement that must be distinguished from his earlier statement of 15 March 1946 that a minority would not be allowed to place a veto on the progress of the majority. C. Direct Action Day on 16 August 1946 was a Muslim League political call issued after the constitutional deadlock; in Calcutta it was followed by the killings remembered as the Great Calcutta Killings, and the political call, the Calcutta violence and the later regional violence are three separable things that a careful answer keeps distinct. D. Communal violence spread through Noakhali, Bihar and the Punjab in 1946-47 in reciprocal waves driven by organisations, local leaderships, rumour and armed bands; agency must be assigned to those organisations and leaderships and never to whole communities, and no religious community may be described as collectively guilty.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Cabinet Mission of 1946 rejected a sovereign Pakistan and proposed a united three-tier scheme of Union, groups and provinces; it attempted to preserve unity and did not partition India, so Partition must be explained by the collapse of that scheme and by what followed it rather than by the Mission itself. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under Cabinet Mission attempted unity?

A. Attlee announced on 20 February 1947 that Britain would transfer power to responsible Indian hands not later than June 1948, an announcement that must be distinguished from his earlier statement of 15 March 1946 that a minority would not be allowed to place a veto on the progress of the majority. B. The Cabinet Mission of 1946 rejected a sovereign Pakistan and proposed a united three-tier scheme of Union, groups and provinces; it attempted to preserve unity and did not partition India, so Partition must be explained by the collapse of that scheme and by what followed it rather than by the Mission itself. C. Lord Mountbatten arrived in March 1947 as the last Viceroy and converted the June 1948 outer limit into a far shorter timetable; the acceleration is an analytical fact about how Partition was executed and about the disorder that followed, not an explanation of why Partition was chosen. D. Communal violence spread through Noakhali, Bihar and the Punjab in 1946-47 in reciprocal waves driven by organisations, local leaderships, rumour and armed bands; agency must be assigned to those organisations and leaderships and never to whole communities, and no religious community may be described as collectively guilty.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Cabinet Mission of 1946 rejected a sovereign Pakistan and proposed a united three-tier scheme of Union, groups and provinces; it attempted to preserve unity and did not partition India, so Partition must be explained by the collapse of that scheme and by what followed it rather than by the Mission itself. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q3. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Cabinet Mission attempted unity?

A. Lord Mountbatten arrived in March 1947 as the last Viceroy and converted the June 1948 outer limit into a far shorter timetable; the acceleration is an analytical fact about how Partition was executed and about the disorder that followed, not an explanation of why Partition was chosen. B. Attlee announced on 20 February 1947 that Britain would transfer power to responsible Indian hands not later than June 1948, an announcement that must be distinguished from his earlier statement of 15 March 1946 that a minority would not be allowed to place a veto on the progress of the majority. C. The Cabinet Mission of 1946 rejected a sovereign Pakistan and proposed a united three-tier scheme of Union, groups and provinces; it attempted to preserve unity and did not partition India, so Partition must be explained by the collapse of that scheme and by what followed it rather than by the Mission itself. D. The Mountbatten Plan

announced on 3 June 1947 was a political plan: it accepted Partition and provided for the division of Punjab and Bengal, referendums in the North-West Frontier Province and Sylhet, and boundary commissions; it was not an Act of Parliament and did not by itself transfer power.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Cabinet Mission of 1946 rejected a sovereign Pakistan and proposed a united three-tier scheme of Union, groups and provinces; it attempted to preserve unity and did not partition India, so Partition must be explained by the collapse of that scheme and by what followed it rather than by the Mission itself. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q4. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Cabinet Mission attempted unity?

A. Lord Mountbatten arrived in March 1947 as the last Viceroy and converted the June 1948 outer limit into a far shorter timetable; the acceleration is an analytical fact about how Partition was executed and about the disorder that followed, not an explanation of why Partition was chosen. B. The decision to divide Punjab and Bengal was taken by separate votes of the notional Hindu-majority and Muslim-majority halves of each provincial legislative assembly, a legislative mechanism entirely distinct from a popular referendum. C. The Mountbatten Plan announced on 3 June 1947 was a political plan: it accepted Partition and provided for the division of Punjab and Bengal, referendums in the North-West Frontier Province and Sylhet, and boundary commissions; it was not an Act of Parliament and did not by itself transfer power. D. The Cabinet Mission of 1946 rejected a sovereign Pakistan and proposed a united three-tier scheme of Union, groups and provinces; it attempted to preserve unity and did not partition India, so Partition must be explained by the collapse of that scheme and by what followed it rather than by the Mission itself.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Cabinet Mission of 1946 rejected a sovereign Pakistan and proposed a united three-tier scheme of Union, groups and provinces; it attempted to preserve unity and did not partition India, so Partition must be explained by the collapse of that scheme and by what followed it rather than by the Mission itself. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies Direct Action Day, 16 August 1946?

A. Direct Action Day on 16 August 1946 was a Muslim League political call issued after the constitutional deadlock; in Calcutta it was followed by the killings remembered as the Great Calcutta Killings, and the political call, the Calcutta violence and the later regional violence are three separable things that a careful answer keeps distinct. B. Lord Mountbatten arrived in March 1947 as the last Viceroy and converted the June 1948 outer limit into a far shorter timetable; the acceleration is an analytical fact about how Partition was executed and about the disorder that followed, not an explanation of why Partition was chosen. C. Communal violence spread through Noakhali, Bihar and the Punjab in 1946-47 in reciprocal waves driven by organisations, local leaderships, rumour and armed bands; agency must be assigned to those organisations and leaderships and never to whole communities, and no religious community may be described as collectively guilty. D. Attlee announced on 20 February 1947 that Britain would transfer power to responsible Indian hands not later than June 1948, an announcement that must be distinguished from his earlier statement of 15 March 1946 that a minority would not be allowed to place a veto on the progress of the majority.

Answer: A. Explanation: Direct Action Day on 16 August 1946 was a Muslim League political call issued after the constitutional deadlock; in Calcutta it was followed by the killings remembered as the Great Calcutta Killings, and the political call, the Calcutta violence and the later regional violence are three separable things that a careful answer keeps distinct. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q6. Which chronology card should be filed under Direct Action Day, 16 August 1946?

A. Lord Mountbatten arrived in March 1947 as the last Viceroy and converted the June 1948 outer limit into a far shorter timetable; the acceleration is an analytical fact about how Partition was executed and about the disorder that followed, not an explanation of why Partition was chosen. B. Direct Action Day on 16 August 1946 was a Muslim League political call issued after the constitutional deadlock; in Calcutta it was followed by the killings remembered as the Great Calcutta Killings, and the political call, the Calcutta violence and the later regional violence are three separable things that a careful answer keeps distinct. C. The Mountbatten Plan announced on 3 June 1947 was a political plan: it accepted Partition and provided for the division of Punjab and Bengal, referendums in the North-West Frontier Province and Sylhet, and boundary commissions; it was not an Act of Parliament and did not by itself transfer power. D. Attlee announced on 20 February 1947 that Britain would transfer power to responsible Indian hands not later than June 1948, an announcement that must be distinguished from his earlier statement of 15 March 1946 that a minority would not be allowed to place a veto on the progress of the majority.

Answer: B. Explanation: Direct Action Day on 16 August 1946 was a Muslim League political call issued after the constitutional deadlock; in Calcutta it was followed by the killings remembered as the Great Calcutta Killings, and the political call, the Calcutta violence and the later regional violence are three separable things that a careful answer keeps distinct. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q7. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Direct Action Day, 16 August 1946?

A. The decision to divide Punjab and Bengal was taken by separate votes of the notional Hindu-majority and Muslim-majority halves of each provincial legislative assembly, a legislative mechanism entirely distinct from a popular referendum. B. The Mountbatten Plan announced on 3 June 1947 was a political plan: it accepted Partition and provided for the division of Punjab and Bengal, referendums in the North-West Frontier Province and Sylhet, and boundary commissions; it was not an Act of Parliament and did not by itself transfer power. C. Direct Action Day on 16 August 1946 was a Muslim League political call issued after the constitutional deadlock; in Calcutta it was followed by the killings remembered as the Great Calcutta Killings, and the political call, the Calcutta violence and the later regional violence are three separable things that a careful answer keeps distinct. D. Lord Mountbatten arrived in March 1947 as the last Viceroy and converted the June 1948 outer limit into a far shorter timetable; the acceleration is an analytical fact about how Partition was executed and about the disorder that followed, not an explanation of why Partition was chosen.

Answer: C. Explanation: Direct Action Day on 16 August 1946 was a Muslim League political call issued after the constitutional deadlock; in Calcutta it was followed by the killings remembered as the Great Calcutta Killings, and the political call, the Calcutta violence and the later regional violence are three separable things that a careful answer keeps distinct. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q8. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Direct Action Day, 16 August 1946?

A. The Mountbatten Plan announced on 3 June 1947 was a political plan: it accepted Partition and provided for the division of Punjab and Bengal, referendums in the North-West Frontier Province and Sylhet, and boundary commissions; it was not an Act of Parliament and did not by itself transfer power. B. The North-West Frontier Province and the Sylhet district of Assam decided their future by referendum under the 3 June Plan, and both results took them into Pakistan; the Congress-aligned boycott of the North-West Frontier Province poll is standard knowledge rather than a claim drawn from the local owner files, and the referendum route applied only to these two cases. C. The decision to divide Punjab and Bengal was taken by separate votes of the notional Hindu-majority and Muslim-majority halves of each provincial legislative assembly, a legislative mechanism entirely distinct from a popular referendum. D. Direct Action Day on 16 August 1946 was a Muslim League political call issued after the constitutional deadlock; in Calcutta it was followed by the killings remembered as the Great Calcutta Killings, and the political call, the Calcutta violence and the later regional violence are three separable things that a careful answer keeps distinct.

Answer: D. Explanation: Direct Action Day on 16 August 1946 was a Muslim League political call issued after the constitutional deadlock; in Calcutta it was followed by the killings remembered as the Great Calcutta Killings, and the political call, the Calcutta violence and the later regional violence are three separable things that a careful answer keeps distinct. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Regional violence of 1946-47 without collective guilt?

A. Communal violence spread through Noakhali, Bihar and the Punjab in 1946-47 in reciprocal waves driven by organisations, local leaderships, rumour and armed bands; agency must be assigned to those organisations and leaderships and never to whole communities, and no religious community may be described as collectively guilty. B. Attlee announced on 20 February 1947 that Britain would transfer power to responsible Indian hands not later than June 1948, an announcement that must be distinguished from his earlier statement of 15 March 1946 that a minority would not be allowed to place a veto on the progress of the majority. C. The Mountbatten Plan announced on 3 June 1947 was a political plan: it accepted Partition and provided for the division of Punjab and Bengal, referendums in the North-West Frontier Province and Sylhet, and boundary commissions; it was not an Act of Parliament and did not by itself transfer power. D. Lord Mountbatten arrived in March 1947 as the last Viceroy and converted the June 1948 outer limit into a far shorter timetable; the acceleration is an analytical fact about how Partition was executed and about the disorder that followed, not an explanation of why Partition was chosen.

Answer: A. Explanation: Communal violence spread through Noakhali, Bihar and the Punjab in 1946-47 in reciprocal waves driven by organisations, local leaderships, rumour and armed bands; agency must be assigned to those organisations and leaderships and never to whole communities, and no religious community may be described as collectively guilty. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q10. Which chronology card should be filed under Regional violence of 1946-47 without collective guilt?

A. Lord Mountbatten arrived in March 1947 as the last Viceroy and converted the June 1948 outer limit into a far shorter timetable; the acceleration is an analytical fact about how Partition was executed and about the disorder that followed, not an explanation of why Partition was chosen. B. Communal violence spread through Noakhali, Bihar and the Punjab in 1946-47 in reciprocal waves driven by organisations, local leaderships, rumour and armed bands; agency must be assigned to those organisations and leaderships and never to whole communities, and no religious community may be described as collectively guilty. C. The Mountbatten Plan announced on 3 June 1947 was a political plan: it accepted Partition and provided for the division of Punjab and Bengal, referendums in the North-West Frontier Province and Sylhet, and boundary commissions; it was not an Act of Parliament and did not by itself transfer power. D. The decision to divide Punjab and Bengal was taken by separate votes of the notional Hindu-majority and Muslim-majority halves of each provincial legislative assembly, a legislative mechanism entirely distinct from a popular referendum.

Answer: B. Explanation: Communal violence spread through Noakhali, Bihar and the Punjab in 1946-47 in reciprocal waves driven by organisations, local leaderships, rumour and armed bands; agency must be assigned to those organisations and leaderships and never to whole communities, and no religious community may be described as collectively guilty. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q11. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Regional violence of 1946-47 without collective guilt?

A. The North-West Frontier Province and the Sylhet district of Assam decided their future by referendum under the 3 June Plan, and both results took them into Pakistan; the Congress-aligned boycott of the North-West Frontier Province poll is standard knowledge rather than a claim drawn from the local owner files, and the referendum route applied only to these two cases. B. The Mountbatten Plan announced on 3 June 1947 was a political plan: it accepted Partition and provided for the division of Punjab and Bengal, referendums in the North-West Frontier Province and Sylhet, and boundary commissions; it was not an Act of Parliament and did not by itself transfer power. C. Communal violence spread through Noakhali, Bihar and the Punjab in 1946-47 in reciprocal waves driven by organisations, local leaderships, rumour and armed bands; agency must be assigned to those organisations and leaderships and never to whole communities, and no religious community may be described as collectively guilty. D. The decision to divide Punjab and Bengal was taken by separate votes of the notional Hindu-majority and Muslim-majority halves of each provincial legislative assembly, a legislative mechanism entirely distinct from a popular referendum.

Answer: C. Explanation: Communal violence spread through Noakhali, Bihar and the Punjab in 1946-47 in reciprocal waves driven by organisations, local leaderships, rumour and armed bands; agency must be assigned to those organisations and leaderships and never to whole communities, and no religious community may be described as collectively guilty. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q12. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Regional violence of 1946-47 without collective guilt?

A. The North-West Frontier Province and the Sylhet district of Assam decided their future by referendum under the 3 June Plan, and both results took them into Pakistan; the Congress-aligned boycott of the North-West Frontier Province poll is standard knowledge rather than a claim drawn from the local owner files, and the referendum route applied only to these two cases. B. The decision to divide Punjab and Bengal was taken by separate votes of the notional Hindu-majority and Muslim-majority halves of each provincial legislative assembly, a legislative mechanism entirely distinct from a popular referendum. C. The Indian Independence Act received Royal Assent on 18 July 1947 and legally created the two independent dominions of India and Pakistan from 15 August 1947; Pakistan's later observance of 14 August as its national day is a separate commemorative fact and must never be presented as the Act's date of commencement. D. Communal violence spread through Noakhali, Bihar and the Punjab in 1946-47 in reciprocal waves driven by organisations, local leaderships, rumour and armed bands; agency must be assigned to those organisations and leaderships and never to whole communities, and no religious community may be described as collectively guilty.

Answer: D. Explanation: Communal violence spread through Noakhali, Bihar and the Punjab in 1946-47 in reciprocal waves driven by organisations, local leaderships, rumour and armed bands; agency must be assigned to those organisations and leaderships and never to whole communities, and no religious community may be described as collectively guilty. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Attlee's statement of 20 February 1947?

A. Attlee announced on 20 February 1947 that Britain would transfer power to responsible Indian hands not later than June 1948, an announcement that must be distinguished from his earlier statement of 15 March 1946 that a minority would not be allowed to place a veto on the progress of the majority. B. The Mountbatten Plan announced on 3 June 1947 was a political plan: it accepted Partition and provided for the division of Punjab and Bengal, referendums in the North-West Frontier Province and Sylhet, and boundary commissions; it was not an Act of Parliament and did not by itself transfer power. C. Lord Mountbatten arrived in March 1947 as the last Viceroy and converted the June 1948 outer limit into a far shorter timetable; the acceleration is an analytical fact about how Partition was executed and about the disorder that followed, not an explanation of why Partition was chosen. D. The decision to divide Punjab and Bengal was taken by separate votes of the notional Hindu-majority and Muslim-majority halves of each provincial legislative assembly, a legislative mechanism entirely distinct from a popular referendum.

Answer: A. Explanation: Attlee announced on 20 February 1947 that Britain would transfer power to responsible Indian hands not later than June 1948, an announcement that must be distinguished from his earlier statement of 15 March 1946 that a minority would not be allowed to place a veto on the progress of the majority. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q14. Which chronology card should be filed under Attlee's statement of 20 February 1947?

A. The decision to divide Punjab and Bengal was taken by separate votes of the notional Hindu-majority and Muslim-majority halves of each provincial legislative assembly, a legislative mechanism entirely distinct from a popular referendum. B. Attlee announced on 20 February 1947 that Britain would transfer power to responsible Indian hands not later than June 1948, an announcement that must be distinguished from his earlier statement of 15 March 1946 that a minority would not be allowed to place a veto on the progress of the majority. C. The North-West Frontier Province and the Sylhet district of Assam decided their future by referendum under the 3 June Plan, and both results took them into Pakistan; the Congress-aligned boycott of the North-West Frontier Province poll is standard knowledge rather than a claim drawn from the local owner files, and the referendum route applied only to these two cases. D. The

Mountbatten Plan announced on 3 June 1947 was a political plan: it accepted Partition and provided for the division of Punjab and Bengal, referendums in the North-West Frontier Province and Sylhet, and boundary commissions; it was not an Act of Parliament and did not by itself transfer power.

Answer: B. Explanation: Attlee announced on 20 February 1947 that Britain would transfer power to responsible Indian hands not later than June 1948, an announcement that must be distinguished from his earlier statement of 15 March 1946 that a minority would not be allowed to place a veto on the progress of the majority. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q15. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Attlee's statement of 20 February 1947?

A. The North-West Frontier Province and the Sylhet district of Assam decided their future by referendum under the 3 June Plan, and both results took them into Pakistan; the Congress-aligned boycott of the North-West Frontier Province poll is standard knowledge rather than a claim drawn from the local owner files, and the referendum route applied only to these two cases. B. The decision to divide Punjab and Bengal was taken by separate votes of the notional Hindu-majority and Muslim-majority halves of each provincial legislative assembly, a legislative mechanism entirely distinct from a popular referendum. C. Attlee announced on 20 February 1947 that Britain would transfer power to responsible Indian hands not later than June 1948, an announcement that must be distinguished from his earlier statement of 15 March 1946 that a minority would not be allowed to place a veto on the progress of the majority. D. The Indian Independence Act received Royal Assent on 18 July 1947 and legally created the two independent dominions of India and Pakistan from 15 August 1947; Pakistan's later observance of 14 August as its national day is a separate commemorative fact and must never be presented as the Act's date of commencement.

Answer: C. Explanation: Attlee announced on 20 February 1947 that Britain would transfer power to responsible Indian hands not later than June 1948, an announcement that must be distinguished from his earlier statement of 15 March 1946 that a minority would not be allowed to place a veto on the progress of the majority. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q16. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Attlee's statement of 20 February 1947?

A. The North-West Frontier Province and the Sylhet district of Assam decided their future by referendum under the 3 June Plan, and both results took them into Pakistan; the Congress-aligned boycott of the North-West Frontier Province poll is standard knowledge rather than a claim drawn from the local owner files, and the referendum route applied only to these two cases. B. The Indian Independence Act received Royal Assent on 18 July 1947 and legally created the two independent dominions of India and Pakistan from 15 August 1947; Pakistan's later observance of 14 August as its national day is a separate commemorative fact and must never be presented as the Act's date of commencement. C. The Act provided that British paramountcy over the princely states would lapse; paramountcy lapsed and did not pass wholesale to India or to Pakistan, which is precisely why accession had to be negotiated state by state rather than inherited automatically. D. Attlee announced on 20 February 1947 that Britain would transfer power to responsible Indian hands not later than June 1948, an announcement that must be distinguished from his earlier statement of 15 March 1946 that a minority would not be allowed to place a veto on the progress of the majority.

Answer: D. Explanation: Attlee announced on 20 February 1947 that Britain would transfer power to responsible Indian hands not later than June 1948, an announcement that must be distinguished from his earlier statement of 15 March 1946 that a minority would not be allowed to place a veto on the progress of the majority. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Mountbatten as the last Viceroy?

A. Lord Mountbatten arrived in March 1947 as the last Viceroy and converted the June 1948 outer limit into a far shorter timetable; the acceleration is an analytical fact about how Partition was executed and about the disorder that followed, not an explanation of why Partition was chosen. B. The Mountbatten Plan announced on 3 June 1947 was a political plan: it accepted Partition and provided for the division of Punjab and Bengal, referendums in the North-West Frontier Province and Sylhet, and boundary commissions; it was not an Act of Parliament and did not by itself transfer power. C. The decision to divide Punjab and Bengal was taken by separate votes of the notional Hindu-majority and Muslim-majority halves of each provincial legislative assembly, a legislative mechanism entirely distinct from a popular referendum. D. The North-West Frontier Province and the Sylhet district of Assam decided their future by referendum under the 3 June Plan, and both results took them into Pakistan; the Congress-aligned boycott of the North-West Frontier Province poll is standard knowledge rather than a claim drawn from the local owner files, and the referendum route applied only to these two cases.

Answer: A. Explanation: Lord Mountbatten arrived in March 1947 as the last Viceroy and converted the June 1948 outer limit into a far shorter timetable; the acceleration is an analytical fact about how Partition was executed and about the disorder that followed, not an explanation of why Partition was chosen. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q18. Which chronology card should be filed under Mountbatten as the last Viceroy?

A. The North-West Frontier Province and the Sylhet district of Assam decided their future by referendum under the 3 June Plan, and both results took them into Pakistan; the Congress-aligned boycott of the North-West Frontier Province poll is standard knowledge rather than a claim drawn from the local owner files, and the referendum route applied only to these two cases. B. Lord Mountbatten arrived in March 1947 as the last Viceroy and converted the June 1948 outer limit into a far shorter timetable; the acceleration is an analytical fact about how Partition was executed and about the disorder that followed, not an explanation of why Partition was chosen. C. The Indian Independence Act received Royal Assent on 18 July 1947 and legally created the two independent dominions of India and Pakistan from 15 August 1947; Pakistan's later observance of 14 August as its national day is a separate commemorative fact and must never be presented as the Act's date of commencement. D. The decision to divide Punjab and Bengal was taken by separate votes of the notional Hindu-majority and Muslim-majority halves of each provincial legislative assembly, a legislative mechanism entirely distinct from a popular referendum.

Answer: B. Explanation: Lord Mountbatten arrived in March 1947 as the last Viceroy and converted the June 1948 outer limit into a far shorter timetable; the acceleration is an analytical fact about how Partition was executed and about the disorder that followed, not an explanation of why Partition was chosen. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q19. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Mountbatten as the last Viceroy?

A. The Act provided that British paramountcy over the princely states would lapse; paramountcy lapsed and did not pass wholesale to India or to Pakistan, which is precisely why accession had to be negotiated state by state rather than inherited automatically. B. The Indian Independence Act received Royal Assent on 18 July 1947 and legally created the two independent dominions of India and Pakistan from 15 August 1947; Pakistan's later observance of 14 August as its national day is a separate commemorative fact and must never be presented as the Act's date of commencement. C. Lord Mountbatten arrived in March 1947 as the last Viceroy and converted the June 1948 outer limit into a far shorter timetable; the acceleration is an analytical fact about how Partition was executed and about the disorder that followed, not an explanation of why Partition was chosen. D. The North-West Frontier Province and the Sylhet district of Assam decided their future by referendum under the 3 June Plan, and both results took them into Pakistan; the Congress-aligned boycott of the North-West Frontier Province poll is standard knowledge rather than a claim drawn from the local owner files, and the referendum route applied only to these two cases.

Answer: C. Explanation: Lord Mountbatten arrived in March 1947 as the last Viceroy and converted the June 1948 outer limit into a far shorter timetable; the acceleration is an analytical fact about how Partition was executed and about the disorder that followed, not an explanation of why Partition was chosen. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC

elimination.

Q20. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Mountbatten as the last Viceroy?

A. Two separate boundary commissions, one for Punjab and one for Bengal, were chaired by Cyril Radcliffe, a British lawyer with no prior Indian experience; each commission had an equal number of Congress-nominated and League-nominated judges, so when those members divided the decisions fell to the chairman. B. The Indian Independence Act received Royal Assent on 18 July 1947 and legally created the two independent dominions of India and Pakistan from 15 August 1947; Pakistan's later observance of 14 August as its national day is a separate commemorative fact and must never be presented as the Act's date of commencement. C. The Act provided that British paramountcy over the princely states would lapse; paramountcy lapsed and did not pass wholesale to India or to Pakistan, which is precisely why accession had to be negotiated state by state rather than inherited automatically. D. Lord Mountbatten arrived in March 1947 as the last Viceroy and converted the June 1948 outer limit into a far shorter timetable; the acceleration is an analytical fact about how Partition was executed and about the disorder that followed, not an explanation of why Partition was chosen.

Answer: D. Explanation: Lord Mountbatten arrived in March 1947 as the last Viceroy and converted the June 1948 outer limit into a far shorter timetable; the acceleration is an analytical fact about how Partition was executed and about the disorder that followed, not an explanation of why Partition was chosen. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies The 3 June Plan as a political plan?

A. The Mountbatten Plan announced on 3 June 1947 was a political plan: it accepted Partition and provided for the division of Punjab and Bengal, referendums in the North-West Frontier Province and Sylhet, and boundary commissions; it was not an Act of Parliament and did not by itself transfer power. B. The Indian Independence Act received Royal Assent on 18 July 1947 and legally created the two independent dominions of India and Pakistan from 15 August 1947; Pakistan's later observance of 14 August as its national day is a separate commemorative fact and must never be presented as the Act's date of commencement. C. The North-West Frontier Province and the Sylhet district of Assam decided their future by referendum under the 3 June Plan, and both results took them into Pakistan; the Congress-aligned boycott of the North-West Frontier Province poll is standard knowledge rather than a claim drawn from the local owner files, and the referendum route applied only to these two cases. D. The decision to divide Punjab and Bengal was taken by separate votes of the notional Hindu-majority and Muslim-majority halves of each provincial legislative assembly, a legislative mechanism entirely distinct from a popular referendum.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Mountbatten Plan announced on 3 June 1947 was a political plan: it accepted Partition and provided for the division of Punjab and Bengal, referendums in the North-West Frontier Province and Sylhet, and boundary commissions; it was not an Act of Parliament and did not by itself transfer power. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q22. Which chronology card should be filed under The 3 June Plan as a political plan?

A. The Indian Independence Act received Royal Assent on 18 July 1947 and legally created the two independent dominions of India and Pakistan from 15 August 1947; Pakistan's later observance of 14 August as its national day is a separate commemorative fact and must never be presented as the Act's date of commencement. B. The Mountbatten Plan announced on 3 June 1947 was a political plan: it accepted Partition and provided for the division of Punjab and Bengal, referendums in the North-West Frontier Province and Sylhet, and boundary commissions; it was not an Act of Parliament and did not by itself transfer power. C. The Act provided that British paramountcy over the princely states would lapse; paramountcy lapsed and did not pass wholesale to India or to Pakistan, which is precisely why accession had to be negotiated state by state rather than inherited automatically. D. The North-West Frontier Province and the Sylhet district of Assam decided their future by referendum under the 3 June Plan, and both results took them into Pakistan; the Congress-aligned boycott of the North-West Frontier Province poll is standard knowledge rather than a claim drawn from the local owner files, and the referendum route applied only to these two cases.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Mountbatten Plan announced on 3 June 1947 was a political plan: it accepted Partition and provided for the division of Punjab and Bengal, referendums in the North-West Frontier

Province and Sylhet, and boundary commissions; it was not an Act of Parliament and did not by itself transfer power. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q23. Which option should a candidate retain when revising The 3 June Plan as a political plan?

A. The Indian Independence Act received Royal Assent on 18 July 1947 and legally created the two independent dominions of India and Pakistan from 15 August 1947; Pakistan's later observance of 14 August as its national day is a separate commemorative fact and must never be presented as the Act's date of commencement. B. The Act provided that British paramountcy over the princely states would lapse; paramountcy lapsed and did not pass wholesale to India or to Pakistan, which is precisely why accession had to be negotiated state by state rather than inherited automatically. C. The Mountbatten Plan announced on 3 June 1947 was a political plan: it accepted Partition and provided for the division of Punjab and Bengal, referendums in the North-West Frontier Province and Sylhet, and boundary commissions; it was not an Act of Parliament and did not by itself transfer power. D. Two separate boundary commissions, one for Punjab and one for Bengal, were chaired by Cyril Radcliffe, a British lawyer with no prior Indian experience; each commission had an equal number of Congress-nominated and League-nominated judges, so when those members divided the decisions fell to the chairman.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Mountbatten Plan announced on 3 June 1947 was a political plan: it accepted Partition and provided for the division of Punjab and Bengal, referendums in the North-West Frontier Province and Sylhet, and boundary commissions; it was not an Act of Parliament and did not by itself transfer power. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q24. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about The 3 June Plan as a political plan?

A. Two separate boundary commissions, one for Punjab and one for Bengal, were chaired by Cyril Radcliffe, a British lawyer with no prior Indian experience; each commission had an equal number of Congress-nominated and League-nominated judges, so when those members divided the decisions fell to the chairman. B. The Radcliffe awards were published on 17 August 1947, after the transfer of power, so people in many border districts did not know which state they were in when independence came; that delay aggravated uncertainty and flight, but the award alone did not cause all the violence, which had begun long before the line was drawn. C. The Act provided that British paramountcy over the princely states would lapse; paramountcy lapsed and did not pass wholesale to India or to Pakistan, which is precisely why accession had to be negotiated state by state rather than inherited automatically. D. The Mountbatten Plan announced on 3 June 1947 was a political plan: it accepted Partition and provided for the division of Punjab and Bengal, referendums in the North-West Frontier Province and Sylhet, and boundary commissions; it was not an Act of Parliament and did not by itself transfer power.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Mountbatten Plan announced on 3 June 1947 was a political plan: it accepted Partition and provided for the division of Punjab and Bengal, referendums in the North-West Frontier Province and Sylhet, and boundary commissions; it was not an Act of Parliament and did not by itself transfer power. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Assembly votes divided Punjab and Bengal?

A. The decision to divide Punjab and Bengal was taken by separate votes of the notional Hindu-majority and Muslim-majority halves of each provincial legislative assembly, a legislative mechanism entirely distinct from a popular referendum. B. The Act provided that British paramountcy over the princely states would lapse; paramountcy lapsed and did not pass wholesale to India or to Pakistan, which is precisely why accession had to be negotiated state by state rather than inherited automatically. C. The Indian Independence Act received Royal Assent on 18 July 1947 and legally created the two independent dominions of India and Pakistan from 15 August 1947; Pakistan's later observance of 14 August as its national day is a separate commemorative fact and must never be presented as the Act's date of commencement. D. The North-West Frontier Province and the Sylhet district of Assam decided their future by referendum under the 3 June Plan, and both results took them into Pakistan; the Congress-aligned boycott of the North-West Frontier Province poll is standard knowledge rather than a claim drawn from the local owner files, and the referendum route applied only to these two cases.

Answer: A. Explanation: The decision to divide Punjab and Bengal was taken by separate votes of the notional Hindu-majority and Muslim-majority halves of each provincial legislative assembly, a legislative mechanism entirely distinct from a popular referendum. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q26. Which chronology card should be filed under Assembly votes divided Punjab and Bengal?

A. The Indian Independence Act received Royal Assent on 18 July 1947 and legally created the two independent dominions of India and Pakistan from 15 August 1947; Pakistan's later observance of 14 August as its national day is a separate commemorative fact and must never be presented as the Act's date of commencement. B. The decision to divide Punjab and Bengal was taken by separate votes of the notional Hindu-majority and Muslim-majority halves of each provincial legislative assembly, a legislative mechanism entirely distinct from a popular referendum. C. The Act provided that British paramountcy over the princely states would lapse; paramountcy lapsed and did not pass wholesale to India or to Pakistan, which is precisely why accession had to be negotiated state by state rather than inherited automatically. D. Two separate boundary commissions, one for Punjab and one for Bengal, were chaired by Cyril Radcliffe, a British lawyer with no prior Indian experience; each commission had an equal number of Congress-nominated and League-nominated judges, so when those members divided the decisions fell to the chairman.

Answer: B. Explanation: The decision to divide Punjab and Bengal was taken by separate votes of the notional Hindu-majority and Muslim-majority halves of each provincial legislative assembly, a legislative mechanism entirely distinct from a popular referendum. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q27. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Assembly votes divided Punjab and Bengal?

A. Two separate boundary commissions, one for Punjab and one for Bengal, were chaired by Cyril Radcliffe, a British lawyer with no prior Indian experience; each commission had an equal number of Congress-nominated and League-nominated judges, so when those members divided the decisions fell to the chairman. B. The Radcliffe awards were published on 17 August 1947, after the transfer of power, so people in many border districts did not know which state they were in when independence came; that delay aggravated uncertainty and flight, but the award alone did not cause all the violence, which had begun long before the line was drawn. C. The decision to divide Punjab and Bengal was taken by separate votes of the notional Hindu-majority and Muslim-majority halves of each provincial legislative assembly, a legislative mechanism entirely distinct from a popular referendum. D. The Act provided that British paramountcy over the princely states would lapse; paramountcy lapsed and did not pass wholesale to India or to Pakistan, which is precisely why accession had to be negotiated state by state rather than inherited automatically.

Answer: C. Explanation: The decision to divide Punjab and Bengal was taken by separate votes of the notional Hindu-majority and Muslim-majority halves of each provincial legislative assembly, a legislative mechanism entirely distinct from a popular referendum. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q28. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Assembly votes divided Punjab and Bengal?

A. Two separate boundary commissions, one for Punjab and one for Bengal, were chaired by Cyril Radcliffe, a British lawyer with no prior Indian experience; each commission had an equal number of Congress-nominated and League-nominated judges, so when those members divided the decisions fell to the chairman. B. The Radcliffe awards were published on 17 August 1947, after the transfer of power, so people in many border districts did not know which state they were in when independence came; that delay aggravated uncertainty and flight, but the award alone did not cause all the violence, which had begun long before the line was drawn. C. The three instruments of 1947 performed different functions and were separated in time and authority: the 3 June Plan was the political decision, the Indian Independence Act was the legal enactment, and the two Radcliffe awards were the boundary mechanism. D. The decision to divide Punjab and Bengal was taken by separate votes of the notional Hindu-majority and Muslim-majority halves of each provincial legislative assembly, a legislative mechanism entirely distinct from a popular referendum.

Answer: D. Explanation: The decision to divide Punjab and Bengal was taken by separate votes of the notional Hindu-majority and Muslim-majority halves of each provincial legislative assembly, a legislative mechanism entirely distinct from a popular referendum. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Referendums in the North-West Frontier Province and Sylhet?

A. The North-West Frontier Province and the Sylhet district of Assam decided their future by referendum under the 3 June Plan, and both results took them into Pakistan; the Congress-aligned boycott of the North-West Frontier Province poll is standard knowledge rather than a claim drawn from the local owner files, and the referendum route applied only to these two cases. B. Two separate boundary commissions, one for Punjab and one for Bengal, were chaired by Cyril Radcliffe, a British lawyer with no prior Indian experience; each commission had an equal number of Congress-nominated and League-nominated judges, so when those members divided the decisions fell to the chairman. C. The Indian Independence Act received Royal Assent on 18 July 1947 and legally created the two independent dominions of India and Pakistan from 15 August 1947; Pakistan's later observance of 14 August as its national day is a separate commemorative fact and must never be presented as the Act's date of commencement. D. The Act provided that British paramountcy over the princely states would lapse; paramountcy lapsed and did not pass wholesale to India or to Pakistan, which is precisely why accession had to be negotiated state by state rather than inherited automatically.

Answer: A. Explanation: The North-West Frontier Province and the Sylhet district of Assam decided their future by referendum under the 3 June Plan, and both results took them into Pakistan; the Congress-aligned boycott of the North-West Frontier Province poll is standard knowledge rather than a claim drawn from the local owner files, and the referendum route applied only to these two cases. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q30. Which chronology card should be filed under Referendums in the North-West Frontier Province and Sylhet?

A. Two separate boundary commissions, one for Punjab and one for Bengal, were chaired by Cyril Radcliffe, a British lawyer with no prior Indian experience; each commission had an equal number of Congress-nominated and League-nominated judges, so when those members divided the decisions fell to the chairman. B. The North-West Frontier Province and the Sylhet district of Assam decided their future by referendum under the 3 June Plan, and both results took them into Pakistan; the Congress-aligned boycott of the North-West Frontier Province poll is standard knowledge rather than a claim drawn from the local owner files, and the referendum route applied only to these two cases. C. The Act provided that British paramountcy over the princely states would lapse; paramountcy lapsed and did not pass wholesale to India or to Pakistan, which is precisely why accession had to be negotiated state by state rather than inherited automatically. D. The Radcliffe awards were published on 17 August 1947, after the transfer of power, so people in many border districts did not know which state they were in when independence came; that delay aggravated uncertainty and flight, but the award alone did not cause all the violence, which had begun long before the line was drawn.

Answer: B. Explanation: The North-West Frontier Province and the Sylhet district of Assam decided their future by referendum under the 3 June Plan, and both results took them into Pakistan; the Congress-aligned boycott of the North-West Frontier Province poll is standard knowledge rather than a claim drawn from the local owner files, and the referendum route applied only to these two cases. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q31. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Referendums in the North-West Frontier Province and Sylhet?

A. The three instruments of 1947 performed different functions and were separated in time and authority: the 3 June Plan was the political decision, the Indian Independence Act was the legal enactment, and the two Radcliffe awards were the boundary mechanism. B. The Radcliffe awards were published on 17 August 1947, after the transfer of power, so people in many border districts did not know which state they were in when independence came; that delay aggravated uncertainty and flight, but the award alone did not cause all the violence, which had begun long before the line was drawn. C. The North-West Frontier Province and the Sylhet district of Assam decided their future by referendum under the 3 June Plan, and both results took them into Pakistan; the Congress-aligned boycott of the North-West Frontier Province poll is standard knowledge rather than a claim drawn from the local owner files, and the referendum route applied only to these two cases. D. Two separate boundary commissions, one for Punjab and one for Bengal, were chaired by Cyril Radcliffe, a British lawyer with no prior Indian experience; each commission had an equal number of Congress-nominated and League-nominated judges, so when those members divided the decisions fell to the chairman.

Answer: C. Explanation: The North-West Frontier Province and the Sylhet district of Assam decided their future by referendum under the 3 June Plan, and both results took them into Pakistan; the Congress-aligned boycott of the North-West Frontier Province poll is standard knowledge rather than a claim drawn from the local owner files, and the referendum route applied only to these two cases. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q32. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Referendums in the North-West Frontier Province and Sylhet?

A. The Radcliffe awards were published on 17 August 1947, after the transfer of power, so people in many border districts did not know which state they were in when independence came; that delay aggravated uncertainty and flight, but the award alone did not cause all the violence, which had begun long before the line was drawn. B. Congress acceptance of Partition was reluctant and pragmatic rather than programmatic: it followed the constitutional deadlock of 1946, escalating violence and the leadership's judgement that a weak centre with compulsory grouping would produce an ungovernable state, and it must never be presented as long-standing Congress policy. C. The three instruments of 1947 performed different functions and were separated in time and authority: the 3 June Plan was the political decision, the Indian Independence Act was the legal enactment, and the two Radcliffe awards were the boundary mechanism. D. The North-West Frontier Province and the Sylhet district of Assam decided their future by referendum under the 3 June Plan, and both results took them into Pakistan; the Congress-aligned boycott of the North-West Frontier Province poll is standard knowledge rather than a claim drawn from the local owner files, and the referendum route applied only to these two cases.

Answer: D. Explanation: The North-West Frontier Province and the Sylhet district of Assam decided their future by referendum under the 3 June Plan, and both results took them into Pakistan; the Congress-aligned boycott of the North-West Frontier Province poll is standard knowledge rather than a claim drawn from the local owner files, and the referendum route applied only to these two cases. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Indian Independence Act: assent and commencement?

A. The Indian Independence Act received Royal Assent on 18 July 1947 and legally created the two independent dominions of India and Pakistan from 15 August 1947; Pakistan's later observance of 14 August as its national day is a separate commemorative fact and must never be presented as the Act's date of commencement. B. Two separate boundary commissions, one for Punjab and one for Bengal, were chaired by Cyril Radcliffe, a British lawyer with no prior Indian experience; each commission had an equal number of Congress-nominated and League-nominated judges, so when those members divided the decisions fell to the chairman. C. The Radcliffe awards were published on 17 August 1947, after the transfer of power, so people in many border districts did not know which state they were in when independence came; that delay aggravated uncertainty and flight, but the award alone did not cause all the violence, which had begun long before the line was drawn. D. The Act provided that British paramountcy over the princely states would lapse; paramountcy lapsed and did not pass wholesale to India or to Pakistan, which is precisely why accession had to be negotiated state by state rather than inherited automatically.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Indian Independence Act received Royal Assent on 18 July 1947 and legally created the two independent dominions of India and Pakistan from 15 August 1947; Pakistan's later observance of 14 August as its national day is a separate commemorative fact and must never be presented as the Act's date of commencement. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q34. Which chronology card should be filed under Indian Independence Act: assent and commencement?

A. The Radcliffe awards were published on 17 August 1947, after the transfer of power, so people in many border districts did not know which state they were in when independence came; that delay aggravated uncertainty and flight, but the award alone did not cause all the violence, which had begun long before the line was drawn. B. The Indian Independence Act received Royal Assent on 18 July 1947 and legally created the two independent dominions of India and Pakistan from 15 August 1947; Pakistan's later observance of 14 August as its national day is a separate commemorative fact and must never be presented as the Act's date of commencement. C. Two separate boundary commissions, one for Punjab and one for Bengal, were chaired by Cyril Radcliffe, a British lawyer with no prior Indian experience; each commission had an equal number of Congress-nominated and League-nominated judges, so when those members divided the decisions fell to the chairman. D. The three instruments of 1947 performed different functions and were separated in time and authority: the 3 June Plan was the political decision, the Indian Independence Act was the legal enactment, and the two Radcliffe awards were the boundary mechanism.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Indian Independence Act received Royal Assent on 18 July 1947 and legally created the two independent dominions of India and Pakistan from 15 August 1947; Pakistan's later observance of 14 August as its national day is a separate commemorative fact and must never be presented as the Act's date of commencement. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q35. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Indian Independence Act: assent and commencement?

A. The Radcliffe awards were published on 17 August 1947, after the transfer of power, so people in many border districts did not know which state they were in when independence came; that delay aggravated uncertainty and flight, but the award alone did not cause all the violence, which had begun long before the line was drawn. B. The three instruments of 1947 performed different functions and were separated in time and authority: the 3 June Plan was the political decision, the Indian Independence Act was the legal enactment, and the two Radcliffe awards were the boundary mechanism. C. The Indian Independence Act received Royal Assent on 18 July 1947 and legally created the two independent dominions of India and Pakistan from 15 August 1947; Pakistan's later observance of 14 August as its national day is a separate commemorative fact and must never be presented as the Act's date of commencement. D. Congress acceptance of Partition was reluctant and pragmatic rather than programmatic: it followed the constitutional deadlock of 1946, escalating violence and the leadership's judgement that a weak centre with compulsory grouping would produce an ungovernable state, and it must never be presented as long-standing Congress policy.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Indian Independence Act received Royal Assent on 18 July 1947 and legally created the two independent dominions of India and Pakistan from 15 August 1947; Pakistan's later observance of 14 August as its national day is a separate commemorative fact and must never be presented as the Act's date of commencement. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q36. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Indian Independence Act: assent and commencement?

A. Congress acceptance of Partition was reluctant and pragmatic rather than programmatic: it followed the constitutional deadlock of 1946, escalating violence and the leadership's judgement that a weak centre with compulsory grouping would produce an ungovernable state, and it must never be presented as long-standing Congress policy. B. Partition was not made inevitable by the founding of the Muslim League in 1906, by the Lahore Resolution of 1940 or by the elections of 1945-46; it is best explained as cumulative structure plus contingent decisions, and both parties accepted the Cabinet Mission scheme in some form in June and July 1946, after the electoral verdict. C. The three instruments of 1947 performed different functions and were separated in time and authority: the 3 June Plan was the political decision, the Indian Independence Act was the legal enactment, and the two Radcliffe awards were the boundary mechanism. D. The Indian Independence Act received Royal Assent on 18 July 1947 and legally created the two independent dominions of India and Pakistan from 15 August 1947; Pakistan's later observance of 14 August as its national day is a separate commemorative fact and must never be presented as the Act's date of commencement.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Indian Independence Act received Royal Assent on 18 July 1947 and legally created the two independent dominions of India and Pakistan from 15 August 1947; Pakistan's later observance of 14 August as its national day is a separate commemorative fact and must never be presented as the Act's date of commencement. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies The lapse of British paramountcy?

A. The Act provided that British paramountcy over the princely states would lapse; paramountcy lapsed and did not pass wholesale to India or to Pakistan, which is precisely why accession had to be negotiated state by state rather than inherited automatically. B. The Radcliffe awards were published on 17 August 1947, after the transfer of power, so people in many border districts did not know which state they were in when independence came; that delay aggravated uncertainty and flight, but the award alone did not cause all the violence, which had begun long before the line was drawn. C. Two separate boundary commissions, one for Punjab and one for Bengal, were chaired by Cyril Radcliffe, a British lawyer with no prior Indian experience; each commission had an equal number of Congress-nominated and League-nominated judges, so when those members divided the decisions fell to the chairman. D. The three instruments of 1947 performed different functions and were separated in time and authority: the 3 June Plan was the political decision, the Indian Independence Act was the legal enactment, and the two Radcliffe awards were the boundary mechanism.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Act provided that British paramountcy over the princely states would lapse; paramountcy lapsed and did not pass wholesale to India or to Pakistan, which is precisely why accession had to be negotiated state by state rather than inherited automatically. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q38. Which chronology card should be filed under The lapse of British paramountcy?

A. The Radcliffe awards were published on 17 August 1947, after the transfer of power, so people in many border districts did not know which state they were in when independence came; that delay aggravated uncertainty and flight, but the award alone did not cause all the violence, which had begun long before the line was drawn. B. The Act provided that British paramountcy over the princely states would lapse; paramountcy lapsed and did not pass wholesale to India or to Pakistan, which is precisely why accession had to be negotiated state by state rather than inherited automatically. C. Congress acceptance of Partition was reluctant and pragmatic rather than programmatic: it followed the constitutional deadlock of 1946, escalating violence and the leadership's judgement that a weak centre with compulsory grouping would produce an ungovernable state, and it must never be presented as long-standing Congress policy. D. The three instruments of 1947 performed different functions and were separated in time and authority: the 3 June Plan was the political decision, the Indian Independence Act was the legal enactment, and the two Radcliffe awards were the boundary mechanism.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Act provided that British paramountcy over the princely states would lapse; paramountcy lapsed and did not pass wholesale to India or to Pakistan, which is precisely why accession had to be negotiated state by state rather than inherited automatically. This distinction preserves the

Q39. Which option should a candidate retain when revising The lapse of British paramountcy?

A. The three instruments of 1947 performed different functions and were separated in time and authority: the 3 June Plan was the political decision, the Indian Independence Act was the legal enactment, and the two Radcliffe awards were the boundary mechanism. B. Congress acceptance of Partition was reluctant and pragmatic rather than programmatic: it followed the constitutional deadlock of 1946, escalating violence and the leadership's judgement that a weak centre with compulsory grouping would produce an ungovernable state, and it must never be presented as long-standing Congress policy. C. The Act provided that British paramountcy over the princely states would lapse; paramountcy lapsed and did not pass wholesale to India or to Pakistan, which is precisely why accession had to be negotiated state by state rather than inherited automatically. D. Partition was not made inevitable by the founding of the Muslim League in 1906, by the Lahore Resolution of 1940 or by the elections of 1945-46; it is best explained as cumulative structure plus contingent decisions, and both parties accepted the Cabinet Mission scheme in some form in June and July 1946, after the electoral verdict.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Act provided that British paramountcy over the princely states would lapse; paramountcy lapsed and did not pass wholesale to India or to Pakistan, which is precisely why accession had to be negotiated state by state rather than inherited automatically. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q40. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about The lapse of British paramountcy?

A. Partition was not made inevitable by the founding of the Muslim League in 1906, by the Lahore Resolution of 1940 or by the elections of 1945-46; it is best explained as cumulative structure plus contingent decisions, and both parties accepted the Cabinet Mission scheme in some form in June and July 1946, after the electoral verdict. B. Congress acceptance of Partition was reluctant and pragmatic rather than programmatic: it followed the constitutional deadlock of 1946, escalating violence and the leadership's judgement that a weak centre with compulsory grouping would produce an ungovernable state, and it must never be presented as long-standing Congress policy. C. No single-villain explanation survives scrutiny: colonial constitutional engineering from the separate electorates of 1909 onwards and the hasty withdrawal of 1947, the Muslim League's strategy after 1940, Congress calculations about a strong centre, communal organisations on every side, mass fear and violence, and distinct regional dynamics in Punjab, Bengal and the United Provinces each carry part of the explanation. D. The Act provided that British paramountcy over the princely states would lapse; paramountcy lapsed and did not pass wholesale to India or to Pakistan, which is precisely why accession had to be negotiated state by state rather than inherited automatically.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Act provided that British paramountcy over the princely states would lapse; paramountcy lapsed and did not pass wholesale to India or to Pakistan, which is precisely why accession had to be negotiated state by state rather than inherited automatically. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Two Radcliffe boundary commissions?

A. Two separate boundary commissions, one for Punjab and one for Bengal, were chaired by Cyril Radcliffe, a British lawyer with no prior Indian experience; each commission had an equal number of Congress-nominated and League-nominated judges, so when those members divided the decisions fell to the chairman. B. The Radcliffe awards were published on 17 August 1947, after the transfer of power, so people in many border districts did not know which state they were in when independence came; that delay aggravated uncertainty and flight, but the award alone did not cause all the violence, which had begun long before the line was drawn. C. Congress acceptance of Partition was reluctant and pragmatic rather than programmatic: it followed the constitutional deadlock of 1946, escalating violence and the leadership's judgement that a weak centre with compulsory grouping would produce an ungovernable state, and it must never be presented as long-standing Congress policy. D. The three instruments of 1947 performed different functions and were separated in time and authority: the 3 June Plan was the political decision, the Indian Independence Act was the legal enactment, and the two Radcliffe awards were the boundary mechanism.

Answer: A. Explanation: Two separate boundary commissions, one for Punjab and one for Bengal, were chaired by Cyril Radcliffe, a British lawyer with no prior Indian experience; each commission had an equal

number of Congress-nominated and League-nominated judges, so when those members divided the decisions fell to the chairman. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q42. Which chronology card should be filed under Two Radcliffe boundary commissions?

A. The three instruments of 1947 performed different functions and were separated in time and authority: the 3 June Plan was the political decision, the Indian Independence Act was the legal enactment, and the two Radcliffe awards were the boundary mechanism. B. Two separate boundary commissions, one for Punjab and one for Bengal, were chaired by Cyril Radcliffe, a British lawyer with no prior Indian experience; each commission had an equal number of Congress-nominated and League-nominated judges, so when those members divided the decisions fell to the chairman. C. Partition was not made inevitable by the founding of the Muslim League in 1906, by the Lahore Resolution of 1940 or by the elections of 1945-46; it is best explained as cumulative structure plus contingent decisions, and both parties accepted the Cabinet Mission scheme in some form in June and July 1946, after the electoral verdict. D. Congress acceptance of Partition was reluctant and pragmatic rather than programmatic: it followed the constitutional deadlock of 1946, escalating violence and the leadership's judgement that a weak centre with compulsory grouping would produce an ungovernable state, and it must never be presented as long-standing Congress policy.

Answer: B. Explanation: Two separate boundary commissions, one for Punjab and one for Bengal, were chaired by Cyril Radcliffe, a British lawyer with no prior Indian experience; each commission had an equal number of Congress-nominated and League-nominated judges, so when those members divided the decisions fell to the chairman. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q43. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Two Radcliffe boundary commissions?

A. Partition was not made inevitable by the founding of the Muslim League in 1906, by the Lahore Resolution of 1940 or by the elections of 1945-46; it is best explained as cumulative structure plus contingent decisions, and both parties accepted the Cabinet Mission scheme in some form in June and July 1946, after the electoral verdict. B. No single-villain explanation survives scrutiny: colonial constitutional engineering from the separate electorates of 1909 onwards and the hasty withdrawal of 1947, the Muslim League's strategy after 1940, Congress calculations about a strong centre, communal organisations on every side, mass fear and violence, and distinct regional dynamics in Punjab, Bengal and the United Provinces each carry part of the explanation. C. Two separate boundary commissions, one for Punjab and one for Bengal, were chaired by Cyril Radcliffe, a British lawyer with no prior Indian experience; each commission had an equal number of Congress-nominated and League-nominated judges, so when those members divided the decisions fell to the chairman. D. Congress acceptance of Partition was reluctant and pragmatic rather than programmatic: it followed the constitutional deadlock of 1946, escalating violence and the leadership's judgement that a weak centre with compulsory grouping would produce an ungovernable state, and it must never be presented as long-standing Congress policy.

Answer: C. Explanation: Two separate boundary commissions, one for Punjab and one for Bengal, were chaired by Cyril Radcliffe, a British lawyer with no prior Indian experience; each commission had an equal number of Congress-nominated and League-nominated judges, so when those members divided the decisions fell to the chairman. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q44. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Two Radcliffe boundary commissions?

A. Partition was not made inevitable by the founding of the Muslim League in 1906, by the Lahore Resolution of 1940 or by the elections of 1945-46; it is best explained as cumulative structure plus contingent decisions, and both parties accepted the Cabinet Mission scheme in some form in June and July 1946, after the electoral verdict. B. No single-villain explanation survives scrutiny: colonial constitutional engineering from the separate electorates of 1909 onwards and the hasty withdrawal of 1947, the Muslim League's strategy after 1940, Congress calculations about a strong centre, communal organisations on every side, mass fear and violence, and distinct regional dynamics in Punjab, Bengal and the United Provinces each carry part of the explanation. C. Displacement across the new border is commonly estimated at around 10 to 15 million people, and that figure may be used only as a broad estimate; death tolls are contested across a wide range and must not be stated with false precision in any answer. D. Two separate boundary commissions, one for Punjab and one for Bengal, were chaired by Cyril Radcliffe, a British lawyer with no prior Indian experience; each commission had an equal number of Congress-nominated and League-nominated judges, so when those members divided the decisions fell to the chairman.

Answer: D. Explanation: Two separate boundary commissions, one for Punjab and one for Bengal, were chaired by Cyril Radcliffe, a British lawyer with no prior Indian experience; each commission had an equal number of Congress-nominated and League-nominated judges, so when those members divided the decisions fell to the chairman. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Radcliffe awards published on 17 August 1947?

A. The Radcliffe awards were published on 17 August 1947, after the transfer of power, so people in many border districts did not know which state they were in when independence came; that delay aggravated uncertainty and flight, but the award alone did not cause all the violence, which had begun long before the line was drawn. B. The three instruments of 1947 performed different functions and were separated in time and authority: the 3 June Plan was the political decision, the Indian Independence Act was the legal enactment, and the two Radcliffe awards were the boundary mechanism. C. Congress acceptance of Partition was reluctant and pragmatic rather than programmatic: it followed the constitutional deadlock of 1946, escalating violence and the leadership's judgement that a weak centre with compulsory grouping would produce an ungovernable state, and it must never be presented as long-standing Congress policy. D. Partition was not made inevitable by the founding of the Muslim League in 1906, by the Lahore Resolution of 1940 or by the elections of 1945-46; it is best explained as cumulative structure plus contingent decisions, and both parties accepted the Cabinet Mission scheme in some form in June and July 1946, after the electoral verdict.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Radcliffe awards were published on 17 August 1947, after the transfer of power, so people in many border districts did not know which state they were in when independence came; that delay aggravated uncertainty and flight, but the award alone did not cause all the violence, which had begun long before the line was drawn. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q46. Which chronology card should be filed under Radcliffe awards published on 17 August 1947?

A. Congress acceptance of Partition was reluctant and pragmatic rather than programmatic: it followed the constitutional deadlock of 1946, escalating violence and the leadership's judgement that a weak centre with compulsory grouping would produce an ungovernable state, and it must never be presented as long-standing Congress policy. B. The Radcliffe awards were published on 17 August 1947, after the transfer of power, so people in many border districts did not know which state they were in when independence came; that delay aggravated uncertainty and flight, but the award alone did not cause all the violence, which had begun long before the line was drawn. C. Partition was not made inevitable by the founding of the Muslim League in 1906, by the Lahore Resolution of 1940 or by the elections of 1945-46; it is best explained as cumulative structure plus contingent decisions, and both parties accepted the Cabinet Mission scheme in some form in June and July 1946, after the electoral verdict. D. No single-villain explanation survives scrutiny: colonial constitutional engineering from the separate electorates of 1909 onwards and the hasty withdrawal of 1947, the Muslim League's strategy after 1940, Congress calculations about a

strong centre, communal organisations on every side, mass fear and violence, and distinct regional dynamics in Punjab, Bengal and the United Provinces each carry part of the explanation.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Radcliffe awards were published on 17 August 1947, after the transfer of power, so people in many border districts did not know which state they were in when independence came; that delay aggravated uncertainty and flight, but the award alone did not cause all the violence, which had begun long before the line was drawn. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q47. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Radcliffe awards published on 17 August 1947?

A. No single-villain explanation survives scrutiny: colonial constitutional engineering from the separate electorates of 1909 onwards and the hasty withdrawal of 1947, the Muslim League's strategy after 1940, Congress calculations about a strong centre, communal organisations on every side, mass fear and violence, and distinct regional dynamics in Punjab, Bengal and the United Provinces each carry part of the explanation. B. Partition was not made inevitable by the founding of the Muslim League in 1906, by the Lahore Resolution of 1940 or by the elections of 1945-46; it is best explained as cumulative structure plus contingent decisions, and both parties accepted the Cabinet Mission scheme in some form in June and July 1946, after the electoral verdict. C. The Radcliffe awards were published on 17 August 1947, after the transfer of power, so people in many border districts did not know which state they were in when independence came; that delay aggravated uncertainty and flight, but the award alone did not cause all the violence, which had begun long before the line was drawn. D. Displacement across the new border is commonly estimated at around 10 to 15 million people, and that figure may be used only as a broad estimate; death tolls are contested across a wide range and must not be stated with false precision in any answer.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Radcliffe awards were published on 17 August 1947, after the transfer of power, so people in many border districts did not know which state they were in when independence came; that delay aggravated uncertainty and flight, but the award alone did not cause all the violence, which had begun long before the line was drawn. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q48. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Radcliffe awards published on 17 August 1947?

A. Displacement across the new border is commonly estimated at around 10 to 15 million people, and that figure may be used only as a broad estimate; death tolls are contested across a wide range and must not be stated with false precision in any answer. B. At independence Gandhi was in Calcutta and Bengal working for communal peace, not celebrating in Delhi, while Jawaharlal Nehru delivered the 'Tryst with Destiny' speech in the Constituent Assembly; the contrast between the two locations is itself the clearest statement of what that moment meant. C. No single-villain explanation survives scrutiny: colonial constitutional engineering from the separate electorates of 1909 onwards and the hasty withdrawal of 1947, the Muslim League's strategy after 1940, Congress calculations about a strong centre, communal organisations on every side, mass fear and violence, and distinct regional dynamics in Punjab, Bengal and the United Provinces each carry part of the explanation. D. The Radcliffe awards were published on 17 August 1947, after the transfer of power, so people in many border districts did not know which state they were in when independence came; that delay aggravated uncertainty and flight, but the award alone did not cause all the violence, which had begun long before the line was drawn.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Radcliffe awards were published on 17 August 1947, after the transfer of power, so people in many border districts did not know which state they were in when independence came; that delay aggravated uncertainty and flight, but the award alone did not cause all the violence, which had begun long before the line was drawn. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Three instruments, three functions?

A. The three instruments of 1947 performed different functions and were separated in time and authority: the 3 June Plan was the political decision, the Indian Independence Act was the legal enactment, and the two Radcliffe awards were the boundary mechanism. B. Partition was not made inevitable by the founding of the Muslim League in 1906, by the Lahore Resolution of 1940 or by the elections of 1945-46; it is best explained as cumulative structure plus contingent decisions, and both parties accepted the Cabinet Mission scheme in some form in June and July 1946, after the electoral verdict. C. Congress acceptance of Partition was reluctant and pragmatic rather than programmatic: it followed the constitutional deadlock of 1946, escalating violence and the leadership's judgement that a weak centre with compulsory grouping would produce an ungovernable state, and it must never be presented as long-standing Congress policy. D. No single-villain explanation survives scrutiny: colonial constitutional engineering from the separate electorates of 1909 onwards and the hasty withdrawal of 1947, the Muslim League's strategy after 1940, Congress calculations about a strong centre, communal organisations on every side, mass fear and violence, and distinct regional dynamics in Punjab, Bengal and the United Provinces each carry part of the explanation.

Answer: A. Explanation: The three instruments of 1947 performed different functions and were separated in time and authority: the 3 June Plan was the political decision, the Indian Independence Act was the legal enactment, and the two Radcliffe awards were the boundary mechanism. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q50. Which chronology card should be filed under Three instruments, three functions?

A. Displacement across the new border is commonly estimated at around 10 to 15 million people, and that figure may be used only as a broad estimate; death tolls are contested across a wide range and must not be stated with false precision in any answer. B. The three instruments of 1947 performed different functions and were separated in time and authority: the 3 June Plan was the political decision, the Indian Independence Act was the legal enactment, and the two Radcliffe awards were the boundary mechanism. C. Partition was not made inevitable by the founding of the Muslim League in 1906, by the Lahore Resolution of 1940 or by the elections of 1945-46; it is best explained as cumulative structure plus contingent decisions, and both parties accepted the Cabinet Mission scheme in some form in June and July 1946, after the electoral verdict. D. No single-villain explanation survives scrutiny: colonial constitutional engineering from the separate electorates of 1909 onwards and the hasty withdrawal of 1947, the Muslim League's strategy after 1940, Congress calculations about a strong centre, communal organisations on every side, mass fear and violence, and distinct regional dynamics in Punjab, Bengal and the United Provinces each carry part of the explanation.

Answer: B. Explanation: The three instruments of 1947 performed different functions and were separated in time and authority: the 3 June Plan was the political decision, the Indian Independence Act was the legal enactment, and the two Radcliffe awards were the boundary mechanism. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q51. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Three instruments, three functions?

A. At independence Gandhi was in Calcutta and Bengal working for communal peace, not celebrating in Delhi, while Jawaharlal Nehru delivered the 'Tryst with Destiny' speech in the Constituent Assembly; the contrast between the two locations is itself the clearest statement of what that moment meant. B. No single-villain explanation survives scrutiny: colonial constitutional engineering from the separate electorates of 1909 onwards and the hasty withdrawal of 1947, the Muslim League's strategy after 1940, Congress calculations about a strong centre, communal organisations on every side, mass fear and violence, and distinct regional dynamics in Punjab, Bengal and the United Provinces each carry part of the explanation. C. The three instruments of 1947 performed different functions and were separated in time and authority: the 3 June Plan was the political decision, the Indian Independence Act was the legal enactment, and the two Radcliffe awards were the boundary mechanism. D. Displacement across the new border is commonly estimated at around 10 to 15 million people, and that figure may be used only as a broad estimate; death tolls are contested across a wide range and must not be stated with false precision in any answer.

Answer: C. Explanation: The three instruments of 1947 performed different functions and were separated in time and authority: the 3 June Plan was the political decision, the Indian Independence Act was the legal enactment, and the two Radcliffe awards were the boundary mechanism. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q52. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Three instruments, three functions?

A. Legal transfer, political triumph and humanitarian catastrophe are analytically simultaneous: the same weeks produced an unprecedented constitutional transfer in the colonial world, the fulfilment of a mass national movement, and mass displacement and killing that the transfer's speed and its unpoliced boundary directly aggravated. B. Displacement across the new border is commonly estimated at around 10 to 15 million people, and that figure may be used only as a broad estimate; death tolls are contested across a wide range and must not be stated with false precision in any answer. C. At independence Gandhi was in Calcutta and Bengal working for communal peace, not celebrating in Delhi, while Jawaharlal Nehru delivered the 'Tryst with Destiny' speech in the Constituent Assembly; the contrast between the two locations is itself the clearest statement of what that moment meant. D. The three instruments of 1947 performed different functions and were separated in time and authority: the 3 June Plan was the political decision, the Indian Independence Act was the legal enactment, and the two Radcliffe awards were the boundary mechanism.

Answer: D. Explanation: The three instruments of 1947 performed different functions and were separated in time and authority: the 3 June Plan was the political decision, the Indian Independence Act was the legal enactment, and the two Radcliffe awards were the boundary mechanism. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Congress acceptance as reluctant pragmatism?

A. Congress acceptance of Partition was reluctant and pragmatic rather than programmatic: it followed the constitutional deadlock of 1946, escalating violence and the leadership's judgement that a weak centre with compulsory grouping would produce an ungovernable state, and it must never be presented as long-standing Congress policy. B. Partition was not made inevitable by the founding of the Muslim League in 1906, by the Lahore Resolution of 1940 or by the elections of 1945-46; it is best explained as cumulative structure plus contingent decisions, and both parties accepted the Cabinet Mission scheme in some form in June and July 1946, after the electoral verdict. C. No single-villain explanation survives scrutiny: colonial constitutional engineering from the separate electorates of 1909 onwards and the hasty withdrawal of 1947, the Muslim League's strategy after 1940, Congress calculations about a strong centre, communal organisations on every side, mass fear and violence, and distinct regional dynamics in Punjab, Bengal and the United Provinces each carry part of the explanation. D. Displacement across the new border is commonly estimated at around 10 to 15 million people, and that figure may be used only as a broad estimate; death tolls are contested across a wide range and must not be stated with false precision in any answer.

Answer: A. Explanation: Congress acceptance of Partition was reluctant and pragmatic rather than programmatic: it followed the constitutional deadlock of 1946, escalating violence and the leadership's judgement that a weak centre with compulsory grouping would produce an ungovernable state, and it must never be presented as long-standing Congress policy. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q54. Which chronology card should be filed under Congress acceptance as reluctant pragmatism?

A. Displacement across the new border is commonly estimated at around 10 to 15 million people, and that figure may be used only as a broad estimate; death tolls are contested across a wide range and must not be stated with false precision in any answer. B. Congress acceptance of Partition was reluctant and pragmatic rather than programmatic: it followed the constitutional deadlock of 1946, escalating violence and the leadership's judgement that a weak centre with compulsory grouping would produce an ungovernable state, and it must never be presented as long-standing Congress policy. C. No single-villain explanation survives scrutiny: colonial constitutional engineering from the separate electorates of 1909 onwards and the hasty withdrawal of 1947, the Muslim League's strategy after 1940, Congress calculations about a strong centre, communal organisations on every side, mass fear and violence, and distinct regional dynamics in Punjab, Bengal and the United Provinces each carry part of the explanation. D. At independence Gandhi was in Calcutta and Bengal working for communal peace, not celebrating in Delhi, while Jawaharlal Nehru delivered the 'Tryst with Destiny' speech in the Constituent Assembly; the contrast between the two locations is itself the clearest statement of what that moment meant.

Answer: B. Explanation: Congress acceptance of Partition was reluctant and pragmatic rather than programmatic: it followed the constitutional deadlock of 1946, escalating violence and the leadership's judgement that a weak centre with compulsory grouping would produce an ungovernable state, and it must never be presented as long-standing Congress policy. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q55. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Congress acceptance as reluctant pragmatism?

A. Legal transfer, political triumph and humanitarian catastrophe are analytically simultaneous: the same weeks produced an unprecedented constitutional transfer in the colonial world, the fulfilment of a mass national movement, and mass displacement and killing that the transfer's speed and its unpoliced boundary directly aggravated. B. Displacement across the new border is commonly estimated at around 10 to 15 million people, and that figure may be used only as a broad estimate; death tolls are contested across a wide range and must not be stated with false precision in any answer. C. Congress acceptance of Partition was reluctant and pragmatic rather than programmatic: it followed the constitutional deadlock of 1946, escalating violence and the leadership's judgement that a weak centre with compulsory grouping would produce an ungovernable state, and it must never be presented as long-standing Congress policy. D. At independence Gandhi was in Calcutta and Bengal working for communal peace, not celebrating in Delhi, while Jawaharlal Nehru delivered the 'Tryst with Destiny' speech in the Constituent Assembly; the contrast between the two locations is itself the clearest statement of what that moment meant.

Answer: C. Explanation: Congress acceptance of Partition was reluctant and pragmatic rather than programmatic: it followed the constitutional deadlock of 1946, escalating violence and the leadership's judgement that a weak centre with compulsory grouping would produce an ungovernable state, and it must never be presented as long-standing Congress policy. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q56. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Congress acceptance as reluctant pragmatism?

A. At independence Gandhi was in Calcutta and Bengal working for communal peace, not celebrating in Delhi, while Jawaharlal Nehru delivered the 'Tryst with Destiny' speech in the Constituent Assembly; the contrast between the two locations is itself the clearest statement of what that moment meant. B. Partition's aftermath became the new state's first administrative test - refugee rehabilitation, a divided army, civil service and treasury, disrupted rivers, railways and trade, and minority questions on both sides - and it strengthened the constitutional case for a strong centre and for secularism as a state commitment; the Ministry of Culture's observance of Partition Horrors Remembrance Day on 13 and 14 August 2026 in Delhi, Amritsar and Kolkata, with exhibitions, documentaries, survivor testimonies and silent marches, is this package's only current-affairs anchor. C. Legal transfer, political triumph and humanitarian catastrophe are analytically simultaneous: the same weeks produced an unprecedented constitutional transfer in the colonial world, the fulfilment of a mass national movement, and mass displacement and killing that the transfer's speed and its unpoliced boundary directly aggravated. D. Congress acceptance of Partition was reluctant and pragmatic rather than programmatic: it followed the constitutional deadlock of 1946, escalating violence and the leadership's judgement that a weak centre with compulsory grouping would produce an ungovernable state, and it must never be presented as long-standing Congress policy.

Answer: D. Explanation: Congress acceptance of Partition was reluctant and pragmatic rather than programmatic: it followed the constitutional deadlock of 1946, escalating violence and the leadership's judgement that a weak centre with compulsory grouping would produce an ungovernable state, and it must never be presented as long-standing Congress policy. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Partition was not inevitable in 1906, 1940 or 1946?

A. Partition was not made inevitable by the founding of the Muslim League in 1906, by the Lahore Resolution of 1940 or by the elections of 1945-46; it is best explained as cumulative structure plus contingent decisions, and both parties accepted the Cabinet Mission scheme in some form in June and July 1946, after the electoral verdict. B. Displacement across the new border is commonly estimated at around 10 to 15 million people, and that figure may be used only as a broad estimate; death tolls are contested across a wide range and must not be stated with false precision in any answer. C. At independence Gandhi was in Calcutta and Bengal working for communal peace, not celebrating in Delhi, while Jawaharlal Nehru delivered the 'Tryst with Destiny' speech in the Constituent Assembly; the contrast between the two locations is itself the clearest statement of what that moment meant. D. No single-villain explanation survives scrutiny: colonial constitutional engineering from the separate electorates of 1909 onwards and the hasty withdrawal of 1947, the Muslim League's strategy after 1940, Congress calculations about a strong centre, communal organisations on every side, mass fear and violence, and distinct regional dynamics in Punjab, Bengal and the United Provinces each carry part of the explanation.

Answer: A. Explanation: Partition was not made inevitable by the founding of the Muslim League in 1906, by the Lahore Resolution of 1940 or by the elections of 1945-46; it is best explained as cumulative structure plus contingent decisions, and both parties accepted the Cabinet Mission scheme in some form in June and July 1946, after the electoral verdict. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q58. Which chronology card should be filed under Partition was not inevitable in 1906, 1940 or 1946?

A. Displacement across the new border is commonly estimated at around 10 to 15 million people, and that figure may be used only as a broad estimate; death tolls are contested across a wide range and must not be stated with false precision in any answer. B. Partition was not made inevitable by the founding of the Muslim League in 1906, by the Lahore Resolution of 1940 or by the elections of 1945-46; it is best explained as cumulative structure plus contingent decisions, and both parties accepted the Cabinet Mission scheme in some form in June and July 1946, after the electoral verdict. C. At independence Gandhi was in Calcutta and Bengal working for communal peace, not celebrating in Delhi, while Jawaharlal Nehru delivered the 'Tryst with Destiny' speech in the Constituent Assembly; the contrast between the two locations is itself the clearest statement of what that moment meant. D. Legal transfer, political triumph and humanitarian catastrophe are analytically simultaneous: the same weeks produced an unprecedented constitutional transfer in the colonial world, the fulfilment of a mass national movement, and mass displacement and killing that the transfer's speed and its unpoliced boundary directly aggravated.

Answer: B. Explanation: Partition was not made inevitable by the founding of the Muslim League in 1906, by the Lahore Resolution of 1940 or by the elections of 1945-46; it is best explained as cumulative structure plus contingent decisions, and both parties accepted the Cabinet Mission scheme in some form in June and July 1946, after the electoral verdict. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q59. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Partition was not inevitable in 1906, 1940 or 1946?

A. At independence Gandhi was in Calcutta and Bengal working for communal peace, not celebrating in Delhi, while Jawaharlal Nehru delivered the 'Tryst with Destiny' speech in the Constituent Assembly; the contrast between the two locations is itself the clearest statement of what that moment meant. B. Partition's aftermath became the new state's first administrative test - refugee rehabilitation, a divided army, civil service and treasury, disrupted rivers, railways and trade, and minority questions on both sides - and it strengthened the constitutional case for a strong centre and for secularism as a state commitment; the Ministry of Culture's observance of Partition Horrors Remembrance Day on 13 and 14 August 2026 in Delhi, Amritsar and Kolkata, with exhibitions, documentaries, survivor testimonies and silent marches, is this package's only current-affairs anchor. C. Partition was not made inevitable by the founding of the Muslim League in 1906, by the Lahore Resolution of 1940 or by the elections of 1945-46; it is best explained as cumulative structure plus contingent decisions, and both parties accepted the Cabinet Mission scheme in some form in June and July 1946, after the electoral verdict. D. Legal transfer, political triumph and humanitarian catastrophe are analytically simultaneous: the same weeks produced an unprecedented constitutional transfer in the colonial world,

the fulfilment of a mass national movement, and mass displacement and killing that the transfer's speed and its unpoliced boundary directly aggravated.

Answer: C. Explanation: Partition was not made inevitable by the founding of the Muslim League in 1906, by the Lahore Resolution of 1940 or by the elections of 1945-46; it is best explained as cumulative structure plus contingent decisions, and both parties accepted the Cabinet Mission scheme in some form in June and July 1946, after the electoral verdict. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q60. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Partition was not inevitable in 1906, 1940 or 1946?

A. The Cabinet Mission of 1946 rejected a sovereign Pakistan and proposed a united three-tier scheme of Union, groups and provinces; it attempted to preserve unity and did not partition India, so Partition must be explained by the collapse of that scheme and by what followed it rather than by the Mission itself. B. Legal transfer, political triumph and humanitarian catastrophe are analytically simultaneous: the same weeks produced an unprecedented constitutional transfer in the colonial world, the fulfilment of a mass national movement, and mass displacement and killing that the transfer's speed and its unpoliced boundary directly aggravated. C. Partition's aftermath became the new state's first administrative test - refugee rehabilitation, a divided army, civil service and treasury, disrupted rivers, railways and trade, and minority questions on both sides - and it strengthened the constitutional case for a strong centre and for secularism as a state commitment; the Ministry of Culture's observance of Partition Horrors Remembrance Day on 13 and 14 August 2026 in Delhi, Amritsar and Kolkata, with exhibitions, documentaries, survivor testimonies and silent marches, is this package's only current-affairs anchor. D. Partition was not made inevitable by the founding of the Muslim League in 1906, by the Lahore Resolution of 1940 or by the elections of 1945-46; it is best explained as cumulative structure plus contingent decisions, and both parties accepted the Cabinet Mission scheme in some form in June and July 1946, after the electoral verdict.

Answer: D. Explanation: Partition was not made inevitable by the founding of the Muslim League in 1906, by the Lahore Resolution of 1940 or by the elections of 1945-46; it is best explained as cumulative structure plus contingent decisions, and both parties accepted the Cabinet Mission scheme in some form in June and July 1946, after the electoral verdict. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies No single-villain explanation?

A. No single-villain explanation survives scrutiny: colonial constitutional engineering from the separate electorates of 1909 onwards and the hasty withdrawal of 1947, the Muslim League's strategy after 1940, Congress calculations about a strong centre, communal organisations on every side, mass fear and violence, and distinct regional dynamics in Punjab, Bengal and the United Provinces each carry part of the explanation. B. At independence Gandhi was in Calcutta and Bengal working for communal peace, not celebrating in Delhi, while Jawaharlal Nehru delivered the 'Tryst with Destiny' speech in the Constituent Assembly; the contrast between the two locations is itself the clearest statement of what that moment meant. C. Displacement across the new border is commonly estimated at around 10 to 15 million people, and that figure may be used only as a broad estimate; death tolls are contested across a wide range and must not be stated with false precision in any answer. D. Legal transfer, political triumph and humanitarian catastrophe are analytically simultaneous: the same weeks produced an unprecedented constitutional transfer in the colonial world, the fulfilment of a mass national movement, and mass displacement and killing that the transfer's speed and its unpoliced boundary directly aggravated.

Answer: A. Explanation: No single-villain explanation survives scrutiny: colonial constitutional engineering from the separate electorates of 1909 onwards and the hasty withdrawal of 1947, the Muslim League's strategy after 1940, Congress calculations about a strong centre, communal organisations on every side, mass fear and violence, and distinct regional dynamics in Punjab, Bengal and the United Provinces each carry part of the explanation. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q62. Which chronology card should be filed under No single-villain explanation?

A. At independence Gandhi was in Calcutta and Bengal working for communal peace, not celebrating in Delhi, while Jawaharlal Nehru delivered the 'Tryst with Destiny' speech in the Constituent Assembly; the contrast between the two locations is itself the clearest statement of what that moment meant. B. No single-villain explanation survives scrutiny: colonial constitutional engineering from the separate electorates of 1909 onwards and the hasty withdrawal of 1947, the Muslim League's strategy after 1940, Congress calculations about a strong centre, communal organisations on every side, mass fear and violence, and distinct regional dynamics in Punjab, Bengal and the United Provinces each carry part of the explanation. C. Partition's aftermath became the new state's first administrative test - refugee rehabilitation, a divided army, civil service and treasury, disrupted rivers, railways and trade, and minority questions on both sides - and it strengthened the constitutional case for a strong centre and for secularism as a state commitment; the Ministry of Culture's observance of Partition Horrors Remembrance Day on 13 and 14 August 2026 in Delhi, Amritsar and Kolkata, with exhibitions, documentaries, survivor testimonies and silent marches, is this package's only current-affairs anchor. D. Legal transfer, political triumph and humanitarian catastrophe are analytically simultaneous: the same weeks produced an unprecedented constitutional transfer in the colonial world, the fulfilment of a mass national movement, and mass displacement and killing that the transfer's speed and its unpoliced boundary directly aggravated.

Answer: B. Explanation: No single-villain explanation survives scrutiny: colonial constitutional engineering from the separate electorates of 1909 onwards and the hasty withdrawal of 1947, the Muslim League's strategy after 1940, Congress calculations about a strong centre, communal organisations on every side, mass fear and violence, and distinct regional dynamics in Punjab, Bengal and the United Provinces each carry part of the explanation. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q63. Which option should a candidate retain when revising No single-villain explanation?

A. Legal transfer, political triumph and humanitarian catastrophe are analytically simultaneous: the same weeks produced an unprecedented constitutional transfer in the colonial world, the fulfilment of a mass national movement, and mass displacement and killing that the transfer's speed and its unpoliced boundary directly aggravated. B. The Cabinet Mission of 1946 rejected a sovereign Pakistan and proposed a united three-tier scheme of Union, groups and provinces; it attempted to preserve unity and did not partition India, so Partition must be explained by the collapse of that scheme and by what followed it rather than by the Mission itself. C. No single-villain explanation survives scrutiny: colonial constitutional engineering from the separate electorates of 1909 onwards and the hasty withdrawal of 1947, the Muslim League's strategy after 1940, Congress calculations about a strong centre, communal organisations on every side, mass fear and violence, and distinct regional dynamics in Punjab, Bengal and the United Provinces each carry part of the explanation. D. Partition's aftermath became the new state's first administrative test - refugee rehabilitation, a divided army, civil service and treasury, disrupted rivers, railways and trade, and minority questions on both sides - and it strengthened the constitutional case for a strong centre and for secularism as a state commitment; the Ministry of Culture's observance of Partition Horrors Remembrance Day on 13 and 14 August 2026 in Delhi, Amritsar and Kolkata, with exhibitions, documentaries, survivor testimonies and silent marches, is this package's only current-affairs anchor.

Answer: C. Explanation: No single-villain explanation survives scrutiny: colonial constitutional engineering from the separate electorates of 1909 onwards and the hasty withdrawal of 1947, the Muslim League's strategy after 1940, Congress calculations about a strong centre, communal organisations on every side, mass fear and violence, and distinct regional dynamics in Punjab, Bengal and the United Provinces each carry part of the explanation. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q64. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about No single-villain explanation?

A. Direct Action Day on 16 August 1946 was a Muslim League political call issued after the constitutional deadlock; in Calcutta it was followed by the killings remembered as the Great Calcutta Killings, and the political call, the Calcutta violence and the later regional violence are three separable things that a careful answer keeps distinct. B. Partition's aftermath became the new state's first administrative test - refugee rehabilitation, a divided army, civil service and treasury, disrupted rivers, railways and trade, and minority questions on both sides - and it strengthened the constitutional case for a strong centre and for secularism as a state commitment; the Ministry of Culture's observance of Partition Horrors Remembrance Day on 13 and 14 August 2026 in Delhi, Amritsar and Kolkata, with exhibitions, documentaries, survivor testimonies and silent marches, is this package's only current-affairs anchor. C. The Cabinet Mission of 1946 rejected a sovereign Pakistan and proposed a united three-tier scheme of Union, groups and provinces; it attempted to preserve unity and did not partition India, so Partition must be explained by the collapse of that scheme and by what followed it rather than by the Mission itself. D. No single-villain explanation survives scrutiny: colonial constitutional engineering from the separate electorates of 1909 onwards and the hasty withdrawal of 1947, the Muslim League's strategy after 1940, Congress calculations about a strong centre, communal organisations on every side, mass fear and violence, and distinct regional dynamics in Punjab, Bengal and the United Provinces each carry part of the explanation.

Answer: D. Explanation: No single-villain explanation survives scrutiny: colonial constitutional engineering from the separate electorates of 1909 onwards and the hasty withdrawal of 1947, the Muslim League's strategy after 1940, Congress calculations about a strong centre, communal organisations on every side, mass fear and violence, and distinct regional dynamics in Punjab, Bengal and the United Provinces each carry part of the explanation. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Displacement as a broad estimate, deaths contested?

A. Displacement across the new border is commonly estimated at around 10 to 15 million people, and that figure may be used only as a broad estimate; death tolls are contested across a wide range and must not be stated with false precision in any answer. B. Partition's aftermath became the new state's first administrative test - refugee rehabilitation, a divided army, civil service and treasury, disrupted rivers, railways and trade, and minority questions on both sides - and it strengthened the constitutional case for a strong centre and for secularism as a state commitment; the Ministry of Culture's observance of Partition Horrors Remembrance Day on 13 and 14 August 2026 in Delhi, Amritsar and Kolkata, with exhibitions, documentaries, survivor testimonies and silent marches, is this package's only current-affairs anchor. C. Legal transfer, political triumph and humanitarian catastrophe are analytically simultaneous: the same weeks produced an unprecedented constitutional transfer in the colonial world, the fulfilment of a mass national movement, and mass displacement and killing that the transfer's speed and its unpoliced boundary directly aggravated. D. At independence Gandhi was in Calcutta and Bengal working for communal peace, not celebrating in Delhi, while Jawaharlal Nehru delivered the 'Tryst with Destiny' speech in the Constituent Assembly; the contrast between the two locations is itself the clearest statement of what that moment meant.

Answer: A. Explanation: Displacement across the new border is commonly estimated at around 10 to 15 million people, and that figure may be used only as a broad estimate; death tolls are contested across a wide range and must not be stated with false precision in any answer. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q66. Which chronology card should be filed under Displacement as a broad estimate, deaths contested?

A. Partition's aftermath became the new state's first administrative test - refugee rehabilitation, a divided army, civil service and treasury, disrupted rivers, railways and trade, and minority questions on both sides - and it strengthened the constitutional case for a strong centre and for secularism as a state commitment; the Ministry of Culture's observance of Partition Horrors Remembrance Day on 13 and 14 August 2026 in Delhi, Amritsar and Kolkata, with exhibitions, documentaries, survivor testimonies and silent marches, is this package's only current-affairs anchor. B. Displacement across the new border is commonly estimated at around 10 to 15 million people, and that figure may be used only as a broad estimate; death tolls are contested across a wide range and must not be stated with false precision in any answer. C. The Cabinet Mission of 1946 rejected a sovereign Pakistan and proposed a united

three-tier scheme of Union, groups and provinces; it attempted to preserve unity and did not partition India, so Partition must be explained by the collapse of that scheme and by what followed it rather than by the Mission itself. D. Legal transfer, political triumph and humanitarian catastrophe are analytically simultaneous: the same weeks produced an unprecedented constitutional transfer in the colonial world, the fulfilment of a mass national movement, and mass displacement and killing that the transfer's speed and its unpoliced boundary directly aggravated.

Answer: B. Explanation: Displacement across the new border is commonly estimated at around 10 to 15 million people, and that figure may be used only as a broad estimate; death tolls are contested across a wide range and must not be stated with false precision in any answer. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q67. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Displacement as a broad estimate, deaths contested?

A. The Cabinet Mission of 1946 rejected a sovereign Pakistan and proposed a united three-tier scheme of Union, groups and provinces; it attempted to preserve unity and did not partition India, so Partition must be explained by the collapse of that scheme and by what followed it rather than by the Mission itself. B. Partition's aftermath became the new state's first administrative test - refugee rehabilitation, a divided army, civil service and treasury, disrupted rivers, railways and trade, and minority questions on both sides - and it strengthened the constitutional case for a strong centre and for secularism as a state commitment; the Ministry of Culture's observance of Partition Horrors Remembrance Day on 13 and 14 August 2026 in Delhi, Amritsar and Kolkata, with exhibitions, documentaries, survivor testimonies and silent marches, is this package's only current-affairs anchor. C. Displacement across the new border is commonly estimated at around 10 to 15 million people, and that figure may be used only as a broad estimate; death tolls are contested across a wide range and must not be stated with false precision in any answer. D. Direct Action Day on 16 August 1946 was a Muslim League political call issued after the constitutional deadlock; in Calcutta it was followed by the killings remembered as the Great Calcutta Killings, and the political call, the Calcutta violence and the later regional violence are three separable things that a careful answer keeps distinct.

Answer: C. Explanation: Displacement across the new border is commonly estimated at around 10 to 15 million people, and that figure may be used only as a broad estimate; death tolls are contested across a wide range and must not be stated with false precision in any answer. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q68. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Displacement as a broad estimate, deaths contested?

A. Direct Action Day on 16 August 1946 was a Muslim League political call issued after the constitutional deadlock; in Calcutta it was followed by the killings remembered as the Great Calcutta Killings, and the political call, the Calcutta violence and the later regional violence are three separable things that a careful answer keeps distinct. B. The Cabinet Mission of 1946 rejected a sovereign Pakistan and proposed a united three-tier scheme of Union, groups and provinces; it attempted to preserve unity and did not partition India, so Partition must be explained by the collapse of that scheme and by what followed it rather than by the Mission itself. C. Communal violence spread through Noakhali, Bihar and the Punjab in 1946-47 in reciprocal waves driven by organisations, local leaderships, rumour and armed bands; agency must be assigned to those organisations and leaderships and never to whole communities, and no religious community may be described as collectively guilty. D. Displacement across the new border is commonly estimated at around 10 to 15 million people, and that figure may be used only as a broad estimate; death tolls are contested across a wide range and must not be stated with false precision in any answer.

Answer: D. Explanation: Displacement across the new border is commonly estimated at around 10 to 15 million people, and that figure may be used only as a broad estimate; death tolls are contested across a wide range and must not be stated with false precision in any answer. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Gandhi in Calcutta, not celebrating in Delhi?

A. At independence Gandhi was in Calcutta and Bengal working for communal peace, not celebrating in Delhi, while Jawaharlal Nehru delivered the 'Tryst with Destiny' speech in the Constituent Assembly; the contrast between the two locations is itself the clearest statement of what that moment meant. B. Legal transfer, political triumph and humanitarian catastrophe are analytically simultaneous: the same weeks produced an unprecedented constitutional transfer in the colonial world, the fulfilment of a mass national movement, and mass displacement and killing that the transfer's speed and its unpoliced boundary directly aggravated. C. Partition's aftermath became the new state's first administrative test - refugee rehabilitation, a divided army, civil service and treasury, disrupted rivers, railways and trade, and minority questions on both sides - and it strengthened the constitutional case for a strong centre and for secularism as a state commitment; the Ministry of Culture's observance of Partition Horrors Remembrance Day on 13 and 14 August 2026 in Delhi, Amritsar and Kolkata, with exhibitions, documentaries, survivor testimonies and silent marches, is this package's only current-affairs anchor. D. The Cabinet Mission of 1946 rejected a sovereign Pakistan and proposed a united three-tier scheme of Union, groups and provinces; it attempted to preserve unity and did not partition India, so Partition must be explained by the collapse of that scheme and by what followed it rather than by the Mission itself.

Answer: A. Explanation: At independence Gandhi was in Calcutta and Bengal working for communal peace, not celebrating in Delhi, while Jawaharlal Nehru delivered the 'Tryst with Destiny' speech in the Constituent Assembly; the contrast between the two locations is itself the clearest statement of what that moment meant. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under Gandhi in Calcutta, not celebrating in Delhi?

A. Partition's aftermath became the new state's first administrative test - refugee rehabilitation, a divided army, civil service and treasury, disrupted rivers, railways and trade, and minority questions on both sides - and it strengthened the constitutional case for a strong centre and for secularism as a state commitment; the Ministry of Culture's observance of Partition Horrors Remembrance Day on 13 and 14 August 2026 in Delhi, Amritsar and Kolkata, with exhibitions, documentaries, survivor testimonies and silent marches, is this package's only current-affairs anchor. B. At independence Gandhi was in Calcutta and Bengal working for communal peace, not celebrating in Delhi, while Jawaharlal Nehru delivered the 'Tryst with Destiny' speech in the Constituent Assembly; the contrast between the two locations is itself the clearest statement of what that moment meant. C. The Cabinet Mission of 1946 rejected a sovereign Pakistan and proposed a united three-tier scheme of Union, groups and provinces; it attempted to preserve unity and did not partition India, so Partition must be explained by the collapse of that scheme and by what followed it rather than by the Mission itself. D. Direct Action Day on 16 August 1946 was a Muslim League political call issued after the constitutional deadlock; in Calcutta it was followed by the killings remembered as the Great Calcutta Killings, and the political call, the Calcutta violence and the later regional violence are three separable things that a careful answer keeps distinct.

Answer: B. Explanation: At independence Gandhi was in Calcutta and Bengal working for communal peace, not celebrating in Delhi, while Jawaharlal Nehru delivered the 'Tryst with Destiny' speech in the Constituent Assembly; the contrast between the two locations is itself the clearest statement of what that moment meant. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q71. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Gandhi in Calcutta, not celebrating in Delhi?

A. Communal violence spread through Noakhali, Bihar and the Punjab in 1946-47 in reciprocal waves driven by organisations, local leaderships, rumour and armed bands; agency must be assigned to those organisations and leaderships and never to whole communities, and no religious community may be described as collectively guilty. B. Direct Action Day on 16 August 1946 was a Muslim League political call issued after the constitutional deadlock; in Calcutta it was followed by the killings remembered as the Great Calcutta Killings, and the political call, the Calcutta violence and the later regional violence are three separable things that a careful answer keeps distinct. C. At independence Gandhi was in Calcutta and Bengal working for communal peace, not celebrating in Delhi, while Jawaharlal Nehru delivered the 'Tryst with Destiny' speech in the Constituent Assembly; the contrast between the two

locations is itself the clearest statement of what that moment meant. D. The Cabinet Mission of 1946 rejected a sovereign Pakistan and proposed a united three-tier scheme of Union, groups and provinces; it attempted to preserve unity and did not partition India, so Partition must be explained by the collapse of that scheme and by what followed it rather than by the Mission itself.

Answer: C. Explanation: At independence Gandhi was in Calcutta and Bengal working for communal peace, not celebrating in Delhi, while Jawaharlal Nehru delivered the 'Tryst with Destiny' speech in the Constituent Assembly; the contrast between the two locations is itself the clearest statement of what that moment meant. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q72. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Gandhi in Calcutta, not celebrating in Delhi?

A. Communal violence spread through Noakhali, Bihar and the Punjab in 1946-47 in reciprocal waves driven by organisations, local leaderships, rumour and armed bands; agency must be assigned to those organisations and leaderships and never to whole communities, and no religious community may be described as collectively guilty. B. Direct Action Day on 16 August 1946 was a Muslim League political call issued after the constitutional deadlock; in Calcutta it was followed by the killings remembered as the Great Calcutta Killings, and the political call, the Calcutta violence and the later regional violence are three separable things that a careful answer keeps distinct. C. Attlee announced on 20 February 1947 that Britain would transfer power to responsible Indian hands not later than June 1948, an announcement that must be distinguished from his earlier statement of 15 March 1946 that a minority would not be allowed to place a veto on the progress of the majority. D. At independence Gandhi was in Calcutta and Bengal working for communal peace, not celebrating in Delhi, while Jawaharlal Nehru delivered the 'Tryst with Destiny' speech in the Constituent Assembly; the contrast between the two locations is itself the clearest statement of what that moment meant.

Answer: D. Explanation: At independence Gandhi was in Calcutta and Bengal working for communal peace, not celebrating in Delhi, while Jawaharlal Nehru delivered the 'Tryst with Destiny' speech in the Constituent Assembly; the contrast between the two locations is itself the clearest statement of what that moment meant. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Three simultaneous registers of independence?

A. Legal transfer, political triumph and humanitarian catastrophe are analytically simultaneous: the same weeks produced an unprecedented constitutional transfer in the colonial world, the fulfilment of a mass national movement, and mass displacement and killing that the transfer's speed and its unpoliced boundary directly aggravated. B. Partition's aftermath became the new state's first administrative test - refugee rehabilitation, a divided army, civil service and treasury, disrupted rivers, railways and trade, and minority questions on both sides - and it strengthened the constitutional case for a strong centre and for secularism as a state commitment; the Ministry of Culture's observance of Partition Horrors Remembrance Day on 13 and 14 August 2026 in Delhi, Amritsar and Kolkata, with exhibitions, documentaries, survivor testimonies and silent marches, is this package's only current-affairs anchor. C. Direct Action Day on 16 August 1946 was a Muslim League political call issued after the constitutional deadlock; in Calcutta it was followed by the killings remembered as the Great Calcutta Killings, and the political call, the Calcutta violence and the later regional violence are three separable things that a careful answer keeps distinct. D. The Cabinet Mission of 1946 rejected a sovereign Pakistan and proposed a united three-tier scheme of Union, groups and provinces; it attempted to preserve unity and did not partition India, so Partition must be explained by the collapse of that scheme and by what followed it rather than by the Mission itself.

Answer: A. Explanation: Legal transfer, political triumph and humanitarian catastrophe are analytically simultaneous: the same weeks produced an unprecedented constitutional transfer in the colonial world, the fulfilment of a mass national movement, and mass displacement and killing that the transfer's speed and its unpoliced boundary directly aggravated. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q74. Which chronology card should be filed under Three simultaneous registers of independence?

A. Communal violence spread through Noakhali, Bihar and the Punjab in 1946-47 in reciprocal waves driven by organisations, local leaderships, rumour and armed bands; agency must be assigned to those organisations and leaderships and never to whole communities, and no religious community may be described as collectively guilty. B. Legal transfer, political triumph and humanitarian catastrophe are analytically simultaneous: the same weeks produced an unprecedented constitutional transfer in the colonial world, the fulfilment of a mass national movement, and mass displacement and killing that the transfer's speed and its unpoliced boundary directly aggravated. C. The Cabinet Mission of 1946 rejected a sovereign Pakistan and proposed a united three-tier scheme of Union, groups and provinces; it attempted to preserve unity and did not partition India, so Partition must be explained by the collapse of that scheme and by what followed it rather than by the Mission itself. D. Direct Action Day on 16 August 1946 was a Muslim League political call issued after the constitutional deadlock; in Calcutta it was followed by the killings remembered as the Great Calcutta Killings, and the political call, the Calcutta violence and the later regional violence are three separable things that a careful answer keeps distinct.

Answer: B. Explanation: Legal transfer, political triumph and humanitarian catastrophe are analytically simultaneous: the same weeks produced an unprecedented constitutional transfer in the colonial world, the fulfilment of a mass national movement, and mass displacement and killing that the transfer's speed and its unpoliced boundary directly aggravated. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q75. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Three simultaneous registers of independence?

A. Communal violence spread through Noakhali, Bihar and the Punjab in 1946-47 in reciprocal waves driven by organisations, local leaderships, rumour and armed bands; agency must be assigned to those organisations and leaderships and never to whole communities, and no religious community may be described as collectively guilty. B. Attlee announced on 20 February 1947 that Britain would transfer power to responsible Indian hands not later than June 1948, an announcement that must be distinguished from his earlier statement of 15 March 1946 that a minority would not be allowed to place a veto on the progress of the majority. C. Legal transfer, political triumph and humanitarian catastrophe are analytically simultaneous: the same weeks produced an unprecedented constitutional transfer in the colonial world, the fulfilment of a mass national movement, and mass displacement and killing that the transfer's speed and its unpoliced boundary directly aggravated. D. Direct Action Day on 16 August 1946 was a Muslim League political call issued after the constitutional deadlock; in Calcutta it was followed by the killings remembered as the Great Calcutta Killings, and the political call, the Calcutta violence and the later regional violence are three separable things that a careful answer keeps distinct.

Answer: C. Explanation: Legal transfer, political triumph and humanitarian catastrophe are analytically simultaneous: the same weeks produced an unprecedented constitutional transfer in the colonial world, the fulfilment of a mass national movement, and mass displacement and killing that the transfer's speed and its unpoliced boundary directly aggravated. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q76. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Three simultaneous registers of independence?

A. Lord Mountbatten arrived in March 1947 as the last Viceroy and converted the June 1948 outer limit into a far shorter timetable; the acceleration is an analytical fact about how Partition was executed and about the disorder that followed, not an explanation of why Partition was chosen. B. Communal violence spread through Noakhali, Bihar and the Punjab in 1946-47 in reciprocal waves driven by organisations, local leaderships, rumour and armed bands; agency must be assigned to those organisations and leaderships and never to whole communities, and no religious community may be described as collectively guilty. C. Attlee announced on 20 February 1947 that Britain would transfer power to responsible Indian hands not later than June 1948, an announcement that must be distinguished from his earlier statement of 15 March 1946 that a minority would not be allowed to place a veto on the progress of the majority. D. Legal transfer, political triumph and humanitarian catastrophe are analytically simultaneous: the same weeks produced an unprecedented constitutional transfer in the colonial world, the fulfilment of a mass national

movement, and mass displacement and killing that the transfer's speed and its unpoliced boundary directly aggravated.

Answer: D. Explanation: Legal transfer, political triumph and humanitarian catastrophe are analytically simultaneous: the same weeks produced an unprecedented constitutional transfer in the colonial world, the fulfilment of a mass national movement, and mass displacement and killing that the transfer's speed and its unpoliced boundary directly aggravated. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Aftermath, institutions and public remembrance?

A. Partition's aftermath became the new state's first administrative test - refugee rehabilitation, a divided army, civil service and treasury, disrupted rivers, railways and trade, and minority questions on both sides - and it strengthened the constitutional case for a strong centre and for secularism as a state commitment; the Ministry of Culture's observance of Partition Horrors Remembrance Day on 13 and 14 August 2026 in Delhi, Amritsar and Kolkata, with exhibitions, documentaries, survivor testimonies and silent marches, is this package's only current-affairs anchor. B. Direct Action Day on 16 August 1946 was a Muslim League political call issued after the constitutional deadlock; in Calcutta it was followed by the killings remembered as the Great Calcutta Killings, and the political call, the Calcutta violence and the later regional violence are three separable things that a careful answer keeps distinct. C. The Cabinet Mission of 1946 rejected a sovereign Pakistan and proposed a united three-tier scheme of Union, groups and provinces; it attempted to preserve unity and did not partition India, so Partition must be explained by the collapse of that scheme and by what followed it rather than by the Mission itself. D. Communal violence spread through Noakhali, Bihar and the Punjab in 1946-47 in reciprocal waves driven by organisations, local leaderships, rumour and armed bands; agency must be assigned to those organisations and leaderships and never to whole communities, and no religious community may be described as collectively guilty.

Answer: A. Explanation: Partition's aftermath became the new state's first administrative test - refugee rehabilitation, a divided army, civil service and treasury, disrupted rivers, railways and trade, and minority questions on both sides - and it strengthened the constitutional case for a strong centre and for secularism as a state commitment; the Ministry of Culture's observance of Partition Horrors Remembrance Day on 13 and 14 August 2026 in Delhi, Amritsar and Kolkata, with exhibitions, documentaries, survivor testimonies and silent marches, is this package's only current-affairs anchor. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Aftermath, institutions and public remembrance?

A. Communal violence spread through Noakhali, Bihar and the Punjab in 1946-47 in reciprocal waves driven by organisations, local leaderships, rumour and armed bands; agency must be assigned to those organisations and leaderships and never to whole communities, and no religious community may be described as collectively guilty. B. Partition's aftermath became the new state's first administrative test - refugee rehabilitation, a divided army, civil service and treasury, disrupted rivers, railways and trade, and minority questions on both sides - and it strengthened the constitutional case for a strong centre and for secularism as a state commitment; the Ministry of Culture's observance of Partition Horrors Remembrance Day on 13 and 14 August 2026 in Delhi, Amritsar and Kolkata, with exhibitions, documentaries, survivor testimonies and silent marches, is this package's only current-affairs anchor. C. Direct Action Day on 16 August 1946 was a Muslim League political call issued after the constitutional deadlock; in Calcutta it was followed by the killings remembered as the Great Calcutta Killings, and the political call, the Calcutta violence and the later regional violence are three separable things that a careful answer keeps distinct. D. Attlee announced on 20 February 1947 that Britain would transfer power to responsible Indian hands not later than June 1948, an announcement that must be distinguished from his earlier statement of 15 March 1946 that a minority would not be allowed to place a veto on the progress of the majority.

Answer: B. Explanation: Partition's aftermath became the new state's first administrative test - refugee rehabilitation, a divided army, civil service and treasury, disrupted rivers, railways and trade, and minority questions on both sides - and it strengthened the constitutional case for a strong centre and for secularism as a state commitment; the Ministry of Culture's observance of Partition Horrors Remembrance Day on 13 and 14 August 2026 in Delhi, Amritsar and Kolkata, with exhibitions, documentaries, survivor testimonies and

silent marches, is this package's only current-affairs anchor. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q79. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Aftermath, institutions and public remembrance?

A. Lord Mountbatten arrived in March 1947 as the last Viceroy and converted the June 1948 outer limit into a far shorter timetable; the acceleration is an analytical fact about how Partition was executed and about the disorder that followed, not an explanation of why Partition was chosen. B. Attlee announced on 20 February 1947 that Britain would transfer power to responsible Indian hands not later than June 1948, an announcement that must be distinguished from his earlier statement of 15 March 1946 that a minority would not be allowed to place a veto on the progress of the majority. C. Partition's aftermath became the new state's first administrative test - refugee rehabilitation, a divided army, civil service and treasury, disrupted rivers, railways and trade, and minority questions on both sides - and it strengthened the constitutional case for a strong centre and for secularism as a state commitment; the Ministry of Culture's observance of Partition Horrors Remembrance Day on 13 and 14 August 2026 in Delhi, Amritsar and Kolkata, with exhibitions, documentaries, survivor testimonies and silent marches, is this package's only current-affairs anchor. D. Communal violence spread through Noakhali, Bihar and the Punjab in 1946-47 in reciprocal waves driven by organisations, local leaderships, rumour and armed bands; agency must be assigned to those organisations and leaderships and never to whole communities, and no religious community may be described as collectively guilty.

Answer: C. Explanation: Partition's aftermath became the new state's first administrative test - refugee rehabilitation, a divided army, civil service and treasury, disrupted rivers, railways and trade, and minority questions on both sides - and it strengthened the constitutional case for a strong centre and for secularism as a state commitment; the Ministry of Culture's observance of Partition Horrors Remembrance Day on 13 and 14 August 2026 in Delhi, Amritsar and Kolkata, with exhibitions, documentaries, survivor testimonies and silent marches, is this package's only current-affairs anchor. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q80. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Aftermath, institutions and public remembrance?

A. The Mountbatten Plan announced on 3 June 1947 was a political plan: it accepted Partition and provided for the division of Punjab and Bengal, referendums in the North-West Frontier Province and Sylhet, and boundary commissions; it was not an Act of Parliament and did not by itself transfer power. B. Attlee announced on 20 February 1947 that Britain would transfer power to responsible Indian hands not later than June 1948, an announcement that must be distinguished from his earlier statement of 15 March 1946 that a minority would not be allowed to place a veto on the progress of the majority. C. Lord Mountbatten arrived in March 1947 as the last Viceroy and converted the June 1948 outer limit into a far shorter timetable; the acceleration is an analytical fact about how Partition was executed and about the disorder that followed, not an explanation of why Partition was chosen. D. Partition's aftermath became the new state's first administrative test - refugee rehabilitation, a divided army, civil service and treasury, disrupted rivers, railways and trade, and minority questions on both sides - and it strengthened the constitutional case for a strong centre and for secularism as a state commitment; the Ministry of Culture's observance of Partition Horrors Remembrance Day on 13 and 14 August 2026 in Delhi, Amritsar and Kolkata, with exhibitions, documentaries, survivor testimonies and silent marches, is this package's only current-affairs anchor.

Answer: D. Explanation: Partition's aftermath became the new state's first administrative test - refugee rehabilitation, a divided army, civil service and treasury, disrupted rivers, railways and trade, and minority questions on both sides - and it strengthened the constitutional case for a strong centre and for secularism as a state commitment; the Ministry of Culture's observance of Partition Horrors Remembrance Day on 13 and 14 August 2026 in Delhi, Amritsar and Kolkata, with exhibitions, documentaries, survivor testimonies and silent marches, is this package's only current-affairs anchor. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.

- **Years represented:** 2021
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2021	Prelims GS-I	50	International Mother Language Day Bangla language movement	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- International Mother Language Day Bangla language movement

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2021 Prelims GS-I Q50

Demand: International Mother Language Day and the Bangla language movement - recorded as a routed demand summary from _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md, which the Basic owner itself flags as unresolved in the locally held sources.

Status: routed-demand-unresolved-locally-no-claim-asserted

Model solution / safe handling: This package deliberately asserts nothing about this demand. The subject matter concerns post-1947 East Pakistan and later Bangladesh and has no supporting content in the source books held here, so no date, event, commemorative designation or option letter is stated. The honest handling is to record the gap, keep the 1946-47 owner's scope intact, and treat this as a single-fact Prelims point to be closed from a verified official source when one is held.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2019 Mains GS-I Q12

Demand: British imperial power and the transfer of power in the 1940s - Assess, 15 marks, 250 words; routed in _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md to the adjacent Topic 26 owner and carried here only as a shared endgame demand, not as a demand owned by this topic.

Status: adjacent-owner-routed-demand-shared-endgame-not-verbatim

Model solution / safe handling: For the 1947 half of this shared demand, assess the transfer through its instruments and their timing: Attlee's statement of 20 February 1947 set the June 1948 outer limit, Mountbatten compressed it, the 3 June Plan supplied the political decision, the Indian Independence Act received Royal Assent on 18 July 1947 and created the dominions from 15 August 1947, and the Radcliffe awards were published on 17 August 1947. Qualify the assessment by noting that paramountcy lapsed rather than passing wholesale to India, and close with the two registers of triumph and catastrophe. No answer key is claimed and no wording here is presented as the official stem.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish the functions of the 3 June Plan, the Indian Independence Act and the two Radcliffe awards in the transfer of power of 1947. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Three different acts of authority - a political decision, a legal enactment and a boundary determination - were separated in time and authority, and that separation is itself part of the explanation of the disorder of August 1947.

Evidence spine:

- The Mountbatten Plan announced on 3 June 1947 was a political plan: it accepted Partition and provided for the division of Punjab and Bengal, referendums in the North-West Frontier Province and Sylhet, and boundary commissions; it was not an Act of Parliament and did not by itself transfer power.
- The Indian Independence Act received Royal Assent on 18 July 1947 and legally created the two independent dominions of India and Pakistan from 15 August 1947; Pakistan's later observance of 14 August as its national day is a separate commemorative fact and must never be presented as the Act's date of commencement.
- The Radcliffe awards were published on 17 August 1947, after the transfer of power, so people in many border districts did not know which state they were in when independence came; that delay aggravated uncertainty and flight, but the award alone did not cause all the violence, which had begun long before the line was drawn.
- The three instruments of 1947 performed different functions and were separated in time and authority: the 3 June Plan was the political decision, the Indian Independence Act was the legal enactment, and the two Radcliffe awards were the boundary mechanism.

Balance: Distinguish intention from outcome, identify regional or social variation, and avoid treating a formal measure as complete implementation.

Conclusion: Three different acts of authority - a political decision, a legal enactment and a boundary determination - were separated in time and authority, and that separation is itself part of the explanation of the disorder of August 1947.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Explain why the Cabinet Mission cannot be described as the instrument that partitioned India. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: The Mission rejected a sovereign Pakistan and offered a united three-tier union, so Partition must be traced to the collapse of that scheme and the decisions that followed it.

Evidence spine:

- The Cabinet Mission of 1946 rejected a sovereign Pakistan and proposed a united three-tier scheme of Union, groups and provinces; it attempted to preserve unity and did not partition India, so Partition must be explained by the collapse of that scheme and by what followed it rather than by the Mission itself.
- Direct Action Day on 16 August 1946 was a Muslim League political call issued after the constitutional deadlock; in Calcutta it was followed by the killings remembered as the Great Calcutta Killings, and the political call, the Calcutta violence and the later regional violence are three separable things that a careful answer keeps distinct.
- Partition was not made inevitable by the founding of the Muslim League in 1906, by the Lahore Resolution of 1940 or by the elections of 1945-46; it is best explained as cumulative structure plus contingent decisions, and both parties accepted the Cabinet Mission scheme in some form in June and July 1946, after the electoral verdict.

Balance: Distinguish intention from outcome, identify regional or social variation, and avoid treating a formal measure as complete implementation.

Conclusion: The Mission rejected a sovereign Pakistan and offered a united three-tier union, so Partition must be traced to the collapse of that scheme and the decisions that followed it.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Examine the mechanisms through which Partition was actually carried out in 1947, distinguishing assembly votes, referendums and boundary commissions. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Partition was executed through three distinct procedures, each with its own constituency and legal character, and conflating them produces both factual error and a false picture of how consent was measured.

Evidence spine:

- The decision to divide Punjab and Bengal was taken by separate votes of the notional Hindu-majority and Muslim-majority halves of each provincial legislative assembly, a legislative mechanism entirely distinct from a popular referendum.
- The North-West Frontier Province and the Sylhet district of Assam decided their future by referendum under the 3 June Plan, and both results took them into Pakistan; the Congress-aligned boycott of the North-West Frontier Province poll is standard knowledge rather than a claim drawn from the local owner files, and the referendum route applied only to these two cases.
- Two separate boundary commissions, one for Punjab and one for Bengal, were chaired by Cyril Radcliffe, a British lawyer with no prior Indian experience; each commission had an equal number of Congress-nominated and League-nominated judges, so when those members divided the decisions fell to the chairman.
- The Radcliffe awards were published on 17 August 1947, after the transfer of power, so people in many border districts did not know which state they were in when independence came; that delay aggravated uncertainty and flight, but the award alone did not cause all the violence, which had begun long before the line was drawn.

Balance: Distinguish intention from outcome, identify regional or social variation, and avoid treating a formal measure as complete implementation.

Conclusion: Partition was executed through three distinct procedures, each with its own constituency and legal character, and conflating them produces both factual error and a false picture of how consent was measured.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Assess Congress's acceptance of Partition in 1947 as a reluctant and pragmatic decision rather than a long-standing policy. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Acceptance followed deadlock, violence and a judgement about governability, so it is best read as a constrained choice made late rather than as a programme pursued early.

Evidence spine:

- The Cabinet Mission of 1946 rejected a sovereign Pakistan and proposed a united three-tier scheme of Union, groups and provinces; it attempted to preserve unity and did not partition India, so Partition must be explained by the collapse of that scheme and by what followed it rather than by the Mission itself.
- Congress acceptance of Partition was reluctant and pragmatic rather than programmatic: it followed the constitutional deadlock of 1946, escalating violence and the leadership's judgement that a weak centre with compulsory grouping would produce an ungovernable state, and it must never be presented as long-standing Congress policy.
- Partition was not made inevitable by the founding of the Muslim League in 1906, by the Lahore Resolution of 1940 or by the elections of 1945-46; it is best explained as cumulative structure plus contingent decisions, and both parties accepted the Cabinet Mission scheme in some form in June and July 1946, after the electoral verdict.
- No single-villain explanation survives scrutiny: colonial constitutional engineering from the separate electorates of 1909 onwards and the hasty withdrawal of 1947, the Muslim League's strategy after 1940, Congress calculations about a strong centre, communal organisations on every side, mass fear and violence, and distinct regional dynamics in Punjab, Bengal and the United Provinces each carry part of the explanation.

Balance: Distinguish intention from outcome, identify regional or social variation, and avoid treating a formal measure as complete implementation.

Conclusion: Acceptance followed deadlock, violence and a judgement about governability, so it is best read as a constrained choice made late rather than as a programme pursued early.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Critically examine the claim that Partition was inevitable, using cumulative structure and contingent decisions rather than a single-villain explanation. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Four decades of communal representation made Partition possible and a chain of datable decisions in 1946 and 1947 made it actual, so inevitability is an interpretive claim rather than a demonstrated fact.

Evidence spine:

- The Cabinet Mission of 1946 rejected a sovereign Pakistan and proposed a united three-tier scheme of Union, groups and provinces; it attempted to preserve unity and did not partition India, so Partition must be explained by the collapse of that scheme and by what followed it rather than by the Mission itself.
- Congress acceptance of Partition was reluctant and pragmatic rather than programmatic: it followed the constitutional deadlock of 1946, escalating violence and the leadership's judgement that a weak centre with compulsory grouping would produce an ungovernable state, and it must never be presented as long-standing Congress policy.
- Partition was not made inevitable by the founding of the Muslim League in 1906, by the Lahore Resolution of 1940 or by the elections of 1945-46; it is best explained as cumulative structure plus contingent decisions, and both parties accepted the Cabinet Mission scheme in some form in June and July 1946, after the electoral verdict.
- No single-villain explanation survives scrutiny: colonial constitutional engineering from the separate electorates of 1909 onwards and the hasty withdrawal of 1947, the Muslim League's strategy after 1940, Congress calculations about a strong centre, communal organisations on every side, mass fear and violence, and distinct regional dynamics in Punjab, Bengal and the United Provinces each carry part of the explanation.

Balance: Distinguish intention from outcome, identify regional or social variation, and avoid treating a formal measure as complete implementation.

Conclusion: Four decades of communal representation made Partition possible and a chain of datable decisions in 1946 and 1947 made it actual, so inevitability is an interpretive claim rather than a demonstrated fact.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Discuss why independence and Partition must be assessed together as legal transfer, political triumph and humanitarian catastrophe. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: The same weeks delivered an unprecedented constitutional transfer, the fulfilment of a mass movement and a displacement crisis, and an answer that records only one register has answered only part of the question.

Evidence spine:

- The Radcliffe awards were published on 17 August 1947, after the transfer of power, so people in many border districts did not know which state they were in when independence came; that delay aggravated uncertainty and flight, but the award alone did not cause all the violence, which had begun long before the line was drawn.
- Displacement across the new border is commonly estimated at around 10 to 15 million people, and that figure may be used only as a broad estimate; death tolls are contested across a wide range and must not be stated with false precision in any answer.
- At independence Gandhi was in Calcutta and Bengal working for communal peace, not celebrating in Delhi, while Jawaharlal Nehru delivered the 'Tryst with Destiny' speech in the Constituent Assembly; the contrast between the two locations is itself the clearest statement of what that moment meant.
- Legal transfer, political triumph and humanitarian catastrophe are analytically simultaneous: the same weeks produced an unprecedented constitutional transfer in the colonial world, the fulfilment of a mass national movement, and mass displacement and killing that the transfer's speed and its unpoliced boundary directly aggravated.

Balance: Distinguish intention from outcome, identify regional or social variation, and avoid treating a formal measure as complete implementation.

Conclusion: The same weeks delivered an unprecedented constitutional transfer, the fulfilment of a mass movement and a displacement crisis, and an answer that records only one register has answered only part of the question.